Tira, Bombay Shaving Co., Inde Wild | WTF is Fueling India’s Beauty & Skincare Revolution? | Ep. 25

Haircare is as personal care. Yeah, you're talking personal care, not haircare. So now, haircare is 7 to 8 billion.

Of which majority is oil by the way. You're confusing us. You're talking about personal care, haircare.

I want to know the breakup of skincare, makeup, hair fragrance. Ready? Start. I thought you would have done a bunch of interviews by now.

No, not too many. Few you would have done. Yeah, few.

Typical CNBC. I've actually never done any CNBC. I've never done any like news things.

I've never done any like, just like, we just did like Vogue Beauty Honours right now. So, like I'll show up there. That's my, that's the extent.

I think we just have to wait for Deepa. Deepa will arrive. You know her already? Yeah, yeah.

Very well. Decently well. We made a plan to catch up last week, but we couldn't.

So, I've never met her. I've never met her. Actually, I've never met Shantanu also.

No, we only interacted on WhatsApp. Her brand is doing very well. Yes.

Like crazy well. She is just launching, if I'm not wrong, in Sephora US. She's doing very well in Sephora UK.

She's doing very well in India. So, she's gotten the right markets. I think her strategy for like, and I think which is like great for like any new founder also, is like, she focused very clearly on like one product.

And which is her Chumpy hair oil, which I think is easily like 50 to 55 percent of her sales. What's the price point? I think it's about 1200 to 1300 rupees, the big one. The big, the big size, I think the 100 ml.

And then it's about, I think 900 for the smaller one. Oil is a tricky market. You know, but her storytelling also, has been really, really good.

Ready? Start. Is it the crew I know? Where are they? No, never mind. No, all good.

Yeah. So, I know Bhakti a bit already because of Bangalore Bangalore. Yeah, the Bangalore connection.

Her husband is also a friend. Okay. He's also a very talented musician, by the way.

Yes. And he's in a band which practices, like 200 meters away from my apartment in Bangalore. Oh God.

And I've been to their jamming sessions. No way. Yeah.

What's his name? What does he do? Tejas, Tejas Goenka. And he is currently Managing Director of Tally Solutions. So, it's a family run, family founded company.

His granddad and his father founded it. And it's a software company. So, I think India's, any small and medium business in India will, you know, do all their innovating, all their inventory on Tally, right? So, I think... Yeah, we all use Tally.

Yeah. It's just, it's become a household name. And yeah, I think it's great to see because I come from a family that's, you know, where I've seen my father work in a professional environment.

And then, you know, you kind of get the exposure to see someone on the other side, to see how, you know, you can carry on family legacy and, you know, build it into something that's modern, that's current, and also transcend different perspectives. Yeah. So, I think he's an engineer.

We met in college, University of Pennsylvania. And we were friends, friends for very long. And then, yeah, we got together.

So, yeah. So, he took this on and... What do you mean got together? I think we decided that we could do, we could be a lot more than friends at another common friend's wedding. So, I think that... In Tally, you know.

I think the pen-pen... Did you get the parents involved? I think the pen-pen connection worked. And yeah, our parents know each other as well. So, that was a bonus.

But it was not a setup. So, I like to say that loud and clear. And yeah, so I think one day we decided that we've been friends for long enough.

And yeah. Yeah, we met in Amsterdam. Yeah, I was just telling Nikhil.

Bhakti and I know each other from Amsterdam. And that's it, we'll stop there. Nothing happened.

Nothing else happened. Nothing else happened. Now, we have to know what happened.

I made them too curious. Honestly, nothing happened. We just had a really good time.

And we saw Deepa's beautiful home. On our boat. And we just had fun.

First time. How did you get to Amsterdam? Where did you begin? Starts with you because I know

them. I know her.

But I'm going to get to know him. I'm the new kid on the block. Yes, Amsterdam.

Okay, let's just... Backwards. So, just Punjabi family. Born in Delhi.

And then mom and dad were both working very hard. So, at one point they put us in boarding school in Ooty. I went to this fantastic... I was just talking on the way here as well.

That boarding schools have a pretty bad rep. I had the best time. And I feel like anybody who comes from boarding school.

Ask them. They've had the best time. So, boarding school kid.

It was an international school. I didn't speak English actually when I got into the boarding school. Hindi was my main language.

And then now my Hindi sucks. And my English is the main language. I never thought you were originally from India.

Yeah, but this boarding school is literally like Harry Potter. You should look it up once. It's called Hebron School.

Do you know the main garden of Ooty? You take one side road. And you enter into this insane world. And I know maybe I'm like romanticizing it now.

But it literally... Our dining hall had long tables like Harry Potter. And we had prefects. And it was this very British school.

Like my teachers were from New Zealand and Korea and the US. And it was this fantastic upbringing. So, after that, my mom and dad started doing business.

Like every Punjabi is a textile business. So, we had a textile business where we were making ski outfits for companies in Switzerland and in Netherlands. And so, when we finished school, they were like, okay, if you want to study anywhere abroad, it has to be the Netherlands.

And I'm like, where on earth is the Netherlands? And then did a little bit of research. I'm like, oh my God, it looks like a sin city. I don't know if I want to go there.

Do they speak English there? Like what's going on? Mom and dad were like, no, we have a base there. So, if you want to go, you can go there. Did a little research, found an amazing bachelor's kind of university there.

And turned out it was a really fun experience. And as kind of, you know, closed off and Christian and very rule-abiding my boarding school was, Amsterdam was the other opposite. So, I always

look at my life in these three phases almost.

Like phase one of me being a really like Indian Indian girl, went to KB, like spoke Hindi, was as like, you know, with the plaids and oil in my hair type, like typical. Then phase two was basically in Hebron, where this international world like just exploded, opened up to me. But still narrow-minded in a way.

And then phase three was Amsterdam, where just every walk of life, every culture, every open-minded philosophy, just, and I met my husband there, who you've met, of course. And then I moved to London to do law for my master's. But my husband and I, at that point, boyfriend, got together.

And then while I was finishing my law school, Instagram, this world of content creation or whatever, back then it didn't even have a term. It was blogging, I think. And Instagram was just starting, that that path kind of found me.

And then I decided, very difficultly in an Indian family, to stop law and start blogging. And my mom was like, 10 years ago or so, 11 years ago. My mom was like, absolutely not.

What is blogging? You're an academic student, straight A, you're not going to get into this Instagram thing. And I was like, mom, trust me, the media landscape is changing. I can see something in the future is going to happen here.

This is the right time, right place. Like, I need to be the first mover here. Like, this is going to be big.

And this was like heydays of like, just beginning Instagram days. It was literally, yeah, like 10 years ago, 2009, 15. And indeed, it was right time, right place.

And I became kind of the first Desi who was globally doing it. Made some insane campaigns, the face of Maybelline, the face of Karestas, was on Piccadilly Circus, Times Square. Every big beauty partnership happened.

And then the pandemic happened. And I think I realized I want more from this journey. By then, I'd done it for six years or so, seven years, this whole Instagram world.

As an academic, I was bored. I'm like, okay, I'm done. I've taken as many photos as one can and done as many videos as one can.

I need the next challenge. And always knew I was going to get into business. Always did.

Like, Punjabi family, dad put it in early. Like, you have to get into business. That's what we do.

But I think I had it in me too. Like, at age 12, I started my first business. I can't call it a business.

But my first little endeavor was friendship bracelets, where I would get my entire class on it. And we would make friendship bracelets. And I would kind of market it.

And they would make it. And so back then already, I knew this was going to become something, this business mind of mine one day. Now here we are.

Nice. Yeah. Where did you start first? What do you mean? In terms of business? IndieWild is my first business.

Well, I can consider the personal brand a business in the way of how big the team is and how we kind of lead it. But I would say IndieWild is like my first business. And how long has it been? Three and a half years.

Nice. Yeah. It's been three and a half years.

What was the first product? Like, the first? The first products were our two skin SKUs. We had the AM and the PM serum, which is basically like 12 serums in one. And the PM is like eight serums in one.

So I call it like the T-shirt and jeans of your skincare, where you don't need the 12-step skincare routine. One product does it all. And then the third one we launched, which is now the crazy viral one.

I did a little PR for you before this. Is the Chumpy hair oil, which has become the household product. And what percentage of your business is in India versus outside? Yeah.

So that has been crazy. So when we launched in the first nine months, IndieWild became the first brand to launch in the US, UK and India. Like that had never been done before.

And was your content background a big like a big steroidal push to like taking it off? 100%. 100%. Like, I think I always say that having a community of 2.5 million was the trampoline jump.

Like it gave the boost, but it's not obviously everything. And you also built your community. I think authentically it took that time because you were in the beauty space.

So I think that's another fun buzzword. Community. Community is everywhere now.

And yeah. I really hope my investors hear this. They're like, why do you do this podcast thing? I'm like, it really helps.

No one talks about shaving. So I need to be in the center of conversation in some way. Because you started after the business started, right? Yeah, much later.

So they're like, oh, this is like a hobby thing. Are you even serious about it? I'm like, no, but I don't have the media budgets of Gillette or Philips or whatever. So I need to be center of conversation.

This is the lowest thing. Unlike beauty. Absolutely.

My business, zero conversation. Like when was the last time you spoke about you're a razor to anyone? Unless it's an investment. No one, no men don't talk.

Maybe you should shave and then people will talk about it. Me? I have trimmers and shavers. So I need to do everything in this real estate.

I shave my head and I trim my beard. No, but I think the founder face, the creator face has become such a common thing in beauty now. Like even Charlotte Tilbury was just a makeup artist.

And that she literally became the face of our brand. And that changed the marketing completely. You know, Rihanna, of course, we know.

Celebrity brands, obviously, is the face of the brand. But even in the US now, brands exploding where their founders after starting the brand become public people. And start posting content.

And how could you? Like how much of your public persona has helped Zerodha, especially in an increasingly comparative world, right? Are you seeing like, like a podcast does well, you suddenly get like a ton of views and then signups go up or? I don't know if there's a direct correlation. You never thought about? I've thought about it. But have I been able to measure it? No.

I hope it goes up. What do I do? Isn't it doing really well already? See, our podcast is very like non-monetary in nature. We don't have advertising or sponsorship or any of that.

In fact, I take money from people who are guests and we do a charity project at the end of it. So it's the opposite of a capitalistic venture. The outcome we're very much going after that we want to elicit is somebody goes and starts a business in what we speak about.

So today, for example, beauty and skincare, I hope when this is out, some young kid or a few of them pick up something that you said and start a business. So today's about that. If we can lay out a roadmap of what the opportunity is in an industry that is growing very fast and we will figure out how to give them the tools they require to solve for a bunch of things that you guys have very successfully solved for.

Bhakti can help most of all. She can just sell their product. Yeah.

Right? So we'll put her phone number and email at the end of it. So thousands of people can reach out to her. Absolutely.

Launch them. Launch them. Please come and list.

But tell us about you next. First of all, thank you for having me here. And you know, so much to

learn from all three of you in very different ways.

Grew up between, so born in the US. My dad was in IT. He was at TCS for many years.

And then grew up in the US, Pune, Bangalore, Trivandrum, Pune. So Pune is where I was from fifth grade to 12th. Very cookie cutter approach to life.

I went to engineering school in Nagpur, business school in IIM Lucknow. So 2005, 2011 education. Joined McKinsey as a consultant in 2011 in the Bombay office.

11 to 16, I was at McKinsey. Long working hours. Yeah, it was the best first job, man.

Yeah, that's true. Best first job. Is consulting dying? Oh, 100%.

Dying is a strong word. But if you don't evolve, like what I did 10 years back is completely irrelevant today. What can they evolve into? I think, I think consultants were hired for two things.

And even today, those two things remain true. One is a bottom-up strategic understanding of a complex problem that any business has. So for Tira, for example, you can say, I need to know, for example, what's an inventory versus marketplace model? What are the SKUs? What's the growth rate? Like you'll have really sharp analysts and they'll probably have AI to help them.

But you don't need that anymore, right? You do. You think? I think so. AI doesn't solve for that? I don't think AI can help you frame problems yet.

Like a business needs to know how to frame the problem. And evolve the framing of the problem constantly. You can't just let them free for six months.

Give me a for instance. Let's say Deepa's brand. Am I saying that right? Deepa? Yeah, it's just because of IIPA, numerology in my parents.

Let's say Deepa's brand, let's say Inderwild has to launch a men's business in India, let's say. And she's like, hey, I think I'm only serving half the market. And I think there is a certain amount of institutional capability that I can do to expand into the other half, for example.

I'm just making this up. I need someone to help me figure this out. So there's a market expansion.

Now they will come back with, let's say a one week answer. Usually at McKinsey, you'll have a one week answer or two week answer. Where you put all the information together and put a hypothesis.

At that point, she has to start helping the team or her team will have to start helping the team. Figuring out, okay, we're going to double click here because this makes sense. But what part of their answer will be useful to her that she can't find herself? And what can I not do in AI? Like market research, I can do.

For example, I don't know, I have not been a consultant for 10 years. So for example, I will at McKinsey, we would immediately know that 20 times this has happened in the world. Immediately get five partners on the phone from Germany, Amsterdam, Brazil, Australia, whatever.

Play it out like you're enacting it. Say I'm Deepa, I call you up, I want to launch a men's brand. Shantanu calls who and asks what? I will find the 10 biggest men's brands expansions like Dove for men, for example.

I'll know the guy in Unilever who would have done the Dove to Dove men expansion and spoken to him about how did it work in China? How did it work in India? What are the 10 insights you found? What are the consumer going through? Then I'll come back to Deepa or I'll come back to you and say, hey, here are the big five things. Word manufacturing or supply chain or marketing. So it's a network then? No, it's the network.

So that's the thing. There is one part of it, which is like very bottom up information gathering and analysis. The second part is a counselor who is just someone who is very senior who will help you think through things.

I've seen that happen a lot. Generally not a specialist in a generalist, right? Because he's never built a skincare brand. Who? Whoever at McKinsey she's talking to.

No, they're not. Obviously never done it themselves. But they're close enough to many people to have at least like a venture capitalist or an investor, right? You have done enough and you're smart enough to do pattern recognition.

But if somebody were, maybe I invested in a skincare brand, but if someone were to ask me, what should I do? I would be the last person they should take. But if you've invested in 15 skincare brands across three fund cycles, you'll probably have the right answer. But then why can't I get this answer from my board member from Unilever Ventures? You know what I mean? That board member, if she would contact her list of people, they would have the same contacts, they would have the same insights.

So math to math, a board member who's from Unilever would probably cost the same as a McKinsey team for three months. So you're one way or the other. Intellectually someone's giving you the money.

How much does it cost? I've never used a consultant. But McKinsey doesn't give me money. Unilever's given her money.

No, no, but for example, that's probably what it would cost. We think about the equity returns you're creating for that individual would probably be the same, probably more. So he's more invested.

A couple of crores a month for a good team. Yeah. Irrespective of my company size.

Depends. So for example, a lot of it... How big is your company, Deepa? In? Sales? So we're gonna cross 100 CR net. And I need to talk in net because I think there's a lot of stuff in the press with GMVs and ARRs and everything else.

So I like talking in net. Net sales after everything is taken out. So net of discounts, returns and cancellation.

Net of what you pay a distributor, for example. Yes. Yes.

Yeah, yeah, yes, yes. It's the invoice value. Yeah, invoice value.

Invoice value. Back to my story, I was at McKinsey for five years. Started Bombay Shaving Company in 2016.

Before I forget, another question. What are multiples in a business like this or that today? Is it four to five weeks? So this is a good part, right? Four to five times revenue if you're growing 40% year on year. If you're growing 20%? Three to four.

Really? No, I think... I've heard differently. Yeah, it can be anywhere between... It really depends on what category you are in as well. So in beauty personal care, there is the moment of transition is when you become profitable.

When you start going from four times revenue, five times revenue to 40 times forward EBITDA. I've heard of cases... That's the transition. With like five to six times on ARR.

Five to six times on revenue is very common right now. You won't value... Like who gets valued at that? How much does Imami value? How much did Minimalist get valued? Hailey Bieber just got her company valued. Hailey Bieber was at four though.

She was at four and a half, five. Minimalist was a very unique case. She made 200 million.

And then she only got 800 now, right? No, her growth is valued at 1 billion. The other one is going to be in three years, I think. Overall got valued at one.

But it is between four and five x of revenue. And I would imagine India is a bit more because the beauty industry is exploding. Exploding and it's also smaller, right? And at smaller scale, you can grow faster and you will get a higher multiple.

And to your question, Minimalist, don't quote me on this, but I think seven or eight. You're on a podcast. You're going to get quoted for sure.

Quote me on them, I think. It's a public information. They were 480 crores top line, 3000 crores net value.

You never really wanted that business. Yeah. And there are... I was reviewing their business to invest, you know.

And I negotiated with them so hard. At what stage? Like a year before this deal. Year and a half before this deal.

So that was not a... Like it would not have been a... Like the venture capital is not super happy with the outcome. No, it was a 40% markup from there. Just tell something.

40, 50%. Of course. 50% in one year is great.

But I still couldn't digest the valuation when... I spent, I think, two, three days with them on the phone. But I couldn't make up my mind to... See, there, at least my view outside is there is a lot of things at play, right? So Unilever is struggling to premiumize. All of their brands, Dove, Ponds, Fair and Lovely, everything is mass... But Minimalist is not premium.

Very premium, yeah. Premium? Compared to their portfolio? No, Minimalist is mastige. Like it's... Mastige.

But compared to their portfolio, compared to the average Unilever price point... Why, Lakme? It's... Lakme is a very smart partner. Okay, another good question for you guys. But if you're talking about beauty per se, this falls between the purview of beauty and... Yeah, so it is kind of between L'Oreal and Unilever.

So it was up for Unilever. Yeah. And new CEO wanting to get into this.

I felt it was one of those... What is premium? What is mass premium? I think Bhakti is a good one to answer that. I think anything over Rs. 1000 to Rs.

1500 is premium. Anything over Rs. 2300 to Rs.

2500 is prestige slash luxury. And everything below? Everything below is mass. Which is so crazy because... Between mass and mastige.

So you can take anything between Rs. 700 to Rs. 1000 as mastige.

And varies about plus minus Rs. 100 on different categories. And then anything below that is mass.

So we're still playing very, very value. Heavily, yeah. Heavily in value, right? And we're talking skincare plus cosmetics.

So how we... Just plainly how we would categorize beauty is just four key main categories. Skincare, fragrance, haircare and makeup. Colour cosmetics.

Okay. So those are four key beauty categories. And then everything else is personal care.

So soap, you'll classify as personal care. But shower gel and shower oil, again, you will classify as... You'll put it in beauty. And skincare is the largest? No, actually, colour cosmetics.

Colour is always the largest. Always. Yeah.

But, you know, they're going kind of neck and neck. Because the lines are also blurring. I think in the past, colour has always been the biggest.

Because it's the Estes and L'Oreal of the world. Exactly. The lipsticks, the mascaras.

It's always been the biggest. Skincare, I think, has been a recent... Dark horse, yeah. Yeah, a recent one where I think the... I think maybe Glossier might have started that trend in a way.

Of, like, really skinifying... Just to qualify, when I think skincare, I'm thinking moisturizers and... Correct. We're talking about that, right? Correct. This is a very... So I'm very curious.

So, for example, for men, these numbers are very different for the categories I operate. No, I think we'll stick to women first. Because I'm guessing the majority of the market is that.

Right? Like 80%? 90%? But changing. But changing, yeah. Yeah, so I think skincare, I think, is maybe... The past seven, six, seven years really took a, like, upward trend.

I think, yeah, the last seven to ten years has been very good on skincare. And I think the way we define beauty has also really changed the concept of, you know... Adoption of skincare, right? Because I think beauty has gone through this journey where it was all about looking good, external validation, you know... We've all seen the ads where you put on a red lipstick or you put on fair and lovely and then you go get the next guy, get the best guy, get the best job, you win a reality TV show. And then that was all about really dominating makeup, right? Because it was about enhancing or making yourself look better.

So it was not really... It was about getting external validation and also telling yourself that I need to have all of this to become better. Then it went on, like, I think the space that when skincare really took off was all about, you know, taking care of your skin, making sure that, you know, you want to take care of yourself. And we're kind of there, but now we've moved into the self-expression zone.

So beauty is all about self-expression and whatever that means to you, right? That comes in the makeup. That is where the journey from makeup, you know, makeup dominating beauty, when whenever, you know, even when we do work with ad agencies, a lot of them, they only look at beauty as makeup, like that's how it went hand in hand. And you kind of started, you know, you ignore all the other categories.

If you look at the services industry, on the other hand, it's all about hair. So skin and makeup services are not huge. Wait, that comes under this? So services is also beauty, right? Like hair services, when you get into like a salon.

70% is all about hair. But when you're talking... Well, I wouldn't consider salon under the beauty pyramid, would you? You're still selling product there, right? Like a Kerastase. You're talking about the products sold at a service, not the treatments.

No, not the treatments. But it's still consumption. But it's still consumption on how people think differently.

Is that a big part of consumption? Salons? Salons used to be huge. In India particularly, all professional hair care brands have started in salons. If you look at Kerastase, they do majority of their business still through salons because... And what does it take to crack a salon? Like if I am a new brand like Kerastase? So India is very fragmented even on the salon space.

So you'll have some... You'll have like 8 to 10 big brands that are dominating different markets, right? Like the North or the West or the South. And you have to actually be able to strike a deal, for example. And it's a Kerastase if they go into any salon.

They don't allow any other brand to be there. Is it like a pharmacy where you pay rent to get shelf space? It's a lot more than that. You have to give them products that you can use on a service.

So you basically craft an entire treatment menu with your product. And then that's how you actually sell your product. Because it's all about the after-sales service and after-sales purchase, right? So if I like a product, if I go to my hairstylist who I trust... Because again, beauty is all about trust.

And believing in someone who you believe is an expert. So when I go to them and my hairstylist tells me, Bhakti, your hair is falling. Why don't you use this serum? And let me use it after I shampoo your hair before blow-dry.

This is how you use it. And oh, the weather is really dry outside. So maybe you should try this shampoo that's moisturizing.

And that'll make your hair hold well in this weather. And then at the end of it, he's used all of that on me. And then he'll be like, listen, do you want to buy it? And I'm like, oh, I really like my hair.

Because again, then it goes back to validation. Does a salon optimize for best quality product? Or the highest kickback or margins? Definitely. I think it's a mix of both, right? Because you also want people to keep coming back to you.

So it's... Like you said, a brand just takes over and says no other brand. Then I guess you're only serving the client one brand. That's why now a lot of salons are also saying no.

We don't mind having three or four brands. Because they cater to all different kinds of products. Like curly hair.

It's huge. But we never speak about curly hair. Like it's a whole segment in itself.

Booming segment in itself. And it's just been started getting addressed now. So that pattern is breaking out.

And I think that's great. Like I've discovered a lot of brands, you know, even international brands through salons. Because they come in through a distributor.

So you can work with a distributor who, you know, have all the best salon connections. Go to them saying, listen, I want to distribute my brand. They'll probably connect you to... If it's a small one to 10 salons.

If it's, you know, your brand is growing bigger than to a chain of salons. And... So I think my experience has been a little bit different. Obviously, Inderwale's hair products are best selling.

We're number one on Nykaa. Number one on Tyra. And we're beating out salon brands like Kerastase.

Like Olaplex. Like others. I don't know the names of all of them.

That really are salon first brands. And I think so there is a change. And I'd say specifically double clicking into Gen Z. Where they want that salon experience at home.

They want it fast. They want it quick. They want to do it themselves.

But they want the level of that expertise and ingredients and salon like feeling. But to be able to do it themselves. And so when you notice.

Even if you look at the new shampoos that are coming out. Everything is so intelligent now. Everything has to be bond repair.

And peptides and proteins and ingredients. Let that the customer feels like. Why would I go to a salon and spend $4,000 on getting the hair done first.

Then get fed these thingies. When I can get it quickly from Tyra by the next morning. And it claims to have all the same things.

Plus the influencer was talking to me about it. Has said you get the same effects. I can see the before and afters.

Like I feel like consumers. Maybe the salon is still a very important for maybe the millennials. And perhaps like our aunties and our moms.

Yeah the older generation. But Gen Z is a lot more like I need it now. Instant gratification.

They want it now. They want it all. I would think like salons are good for sampling.

So the thing that makes brands work in salons. And I think L'Oreal is a fantastic example of this. Is they're able to get a SKU assortment.

Which is larger. So they'll do like 500 ml and 1 litre. And shaving foams they'll do like a 2 kilo pack.

Stuff like that. Vijon will do a good job with that. The customer and the consumer are different.

So the customer is the stylist. The consumer is the person who is doing it all. So the consumer probably gets it done the first time.

And then will come to a Tyra and. As a second purchase. Yeah and will give you how to do this.

Yeah. How much is available on Tyra. And then they do it themselves.

Second thing is. Do they look for the same brand when they're on Tyra? Often times. The second thing that I think.

Really good salon first brands do is. They invest a lot in training. Training.

They'll do a lot of like these. They'll have massive teachers. They'll go into these academies.

They'll call 50 stylists in one go. Keep them for a week. Like take them through it.

So now there's a product. Which is assorted for a salon. Then there is a stylist.

Who's trained to use that product. To their optimum performance. Then the consumer leaves the salon.

Saying hey that was fucking amazing. Exactly. Now I want to come and see how much it's worth.

And then the repeat goes on to. You know any platform. They go on to a Tyra.

And they're like okay. Now we keep buying it. And again.

Going back to what Deepa said. Right. I think that Gen Z is a lot more comfortable.

Figuring it out for themselves. I think the millennials. And you know all the.

Everyone older than that. Is very used to getting it done. So they feel a lot more comfortable saying.

Okay my stylist said. I'll get it you know. Now I feel comfortable.

And I think who we look as experts. Has changed. Exactly.

Like I think millennials look at experts. As the. Trichologists.

Dermatologists. Like salon. Hairdressers.

And the Gen Z is looking at. Influencers. And like you know.

KOLs as their experts. What is KOL? Key opinion leaders. Would you want your brand.

To be in salons at some point? Have you thought about like a salon range? I mean Indie World is such a like. Wellness. Ayurvedic.

Like I can see. That happen. Especially I think a chumpy hair oil.

Like you know. Reinventing the chumpy. In this really cool hair treatment way.

I can see it. But I think. At this point.

We're good with our. Online. And like our retailers.

And I think. Next step perhaps could be more. Spa led first perhaps.

And then the phase after that. Could be salon. Deepa has really nice hair.

Thank you. You need to get my oil. I need to send it to you.

I will send you my oil. Do you oil every day? No that would be crazy. I oil usually once a week.

We call it Sunday chumpy. That's kind of the thing. We've made with our brand.

Where every Sunday. Our community chumpy is with us. Girls go to Pilates.

With oil in their hair. Girls go to groceries. With oil in their hair.

I worked out with her chumpy hair oil. On a Sunday. So it's.

And you keep it on all day? No we keep it on for an hour. Two hours. And then you wash it out.

It's almost honestly. It has become a movement of sorts. With the Gen Z. Because this thing.

The chumpy. The hair oiling. Was a PTSD to all of us growing up.

I mean. I hated it. Like you would have to.

Go to school with it. It would stink. It would be heavy.

Like you just didn't like. The experience of oiling your hair. And especially if you go abroad with it.

You would be made fun of. You know so. Indians abroad.

Indians in India. All of us. Together have this.

Really bad experience of hair oiling. And what Inderwal did. Is we took that very same experience.

Turned it on its head. And made it cool. And now.

There's this clean girl aesthetic. Where it's all about the slick back. And updos.

Do it with the chumpy oil. And so it's become like. Instead of using a wax.

Or a gel. Use this oil. That is really good for your hair.

While you do. A cool style with it. And then.

Really treat your hair every Sunday. And the before and after. Speak for themselves.

So we were ideating. A jewelry brand recently. With lab grown jewelry.

Lab grown diamonds. And two people. We were consulting.

Kishore and Santosh. Biani. They were talking about.

How the youth is buying. Not a new product altogether. But they're buying.

Reimagined old. Yeah. Is that something.

That's working for Chumpy? And do you agree with that analysis? I think 100%. For the brand as a whole. Like Inderwal.

I think really resonates. With the new India. Because we just take.

Age old. Nani ke nuske. Scientifically back it.

Make it super cool. And bring it out again. And I think.

It's definitely. That. Nostalgic element.

That our products give. While it being something. That you're really cool.

To show off to your friends. Like our dewy lip treatments. There are lip balms.

Bhakti loves them. The rose. Yeah the rose.

They basically have ghee in it. Could you ever imagine. A lip balm with ghee in it.

And it is the talk of the town. Like you go. The Seoul house.

Every girl has it on her table. They have it locked to their bags. They have it locked to their jeans.

And it's ghee in a lip balm. But it's so funny. Because when I was growing up.

My mom would tell me. Eat a date. And she would put.

Put ghee inside it. And then she's like. Eat it and whatever's left.

Just put it on your lips. And we've. I've grown up.

Literally with that. Like you know. Put ghee on your lips.

So they don't trap. Yeah. Can we establish market size? You said skincare.

Makeup. Hair and fragrance. How big is this market in India now? You said premium is.

Thousand bucks. Lux and prestigious. Twenty three hundred bucks.

Mass is below that. Women are majority of the market. How big is the market.

And who is buying? Overall. In India. I think beauty personal care.

At this point. In 2024 was 21 billion. Which is so funny.

Because our first investor deck. Had something from McKinsey and Bain. Saying in 2025.

The Indian beauty market. Would be 20 billion. We've already beaten it.

So it's going faster. Than anybody expected. If you double click on beauty itself.

I think. 40 to 45 percent of the market. When you say beauty.

You mean. Skincare. Makeup.

Hair fragrance. Correct. Yeah.

Do Indians still buy. The western narrative. That's such a good question.

Yes. Yes. And no.

Yeah. Explain. You start.

I think that. You know. There was a time.

When a lot of the. When particularly. When Mac entered.

Right. I think. They came.

They had first mover advantage. Entered the market. And really.

Took it by storm. There was no Indian brand. You know.

There was no global brand. Other than Maybelline. And Blackmail.

As we always. All know. Has like you know.

Changed. Changed the game. In the mass segment.

But Mac came in. And kind of you know. We were all.

I think. The millennial generation. Was the first one.

That started you know. Travelling. And going out.

And getting a little bit. Of the taste. Of what.

What beauty was. Glow. You know.

In the western countries. And I. I think that. When that Mac.

Phenomena began. We were all. You know.

Oh wow. This is made. In Italy.

It's made in France. It's come from the UK. It's come from the US.

There was that whole. Enigma. To kind of.

You know. Want. And just be that.

Right. So it was. Whether it was in looks.

Whether it was in. How we believed. What we wanted to be.

Just dressing. Everything was kind of. Aping.

Aping the west. Now I said. As brands started.

Really coming. In the. And the consumer.

Mindset. Started moving. One.

One consumers. Believe that when. Brands are coming from.

A country like. France. Or they're coming from.

A country like Italy. Where they're known to have. Really really good quality.

Ingredients. They want product. That is very very good.

But I think when it comes. When it. Comes to a brand.

And storytelling. And who they identify with. That identification.

Has changed very beautifully. They realized that. They were not seeing people.

Who represent. Who represent them. So I think when it comes.

To what they expect. From a quality perspective. Yes there is a want.

To emulate the west. In product standard. In quality.

In transparency. In how they talk about. Claims in.

You know. I think Europe. Europe has the highest standards.

When it comes to safety. And ingredients. And transparency.

And the consumers. Today in India. Demand exactly that.

Do they want to see. The same kind of. Brand storytelling.

The kind. The same kind of. You know.

They want to see. Who they are. On a global brand as well.

So I think that when you. Global brands are alienating. You know alienating.

Indian consumers. When they don't see someone. Who looks like them in India.

So yeah. That's I think. Anytime a brand is coming.

And I always tell them this. That make sure. You may not get a face.

But you make sure. That you are being able to. Your brand has.

Something that connects. To the Indian consumer. There's.

There's something that speaks. To their unique journey. That's something.

That's dear to them. And their values. So I think that.

That is something. That has changed. And what's not changed.

I think is the standards. But traditionally. The opposite worked right.

Yeah so I think. In India like. Growing up here.

I think. We had a colonial hangover. Like I think everything was.

Don't be still. I would argue less. Or perhaps for many people.

Also not. Because I think. Specifically in the premium.

And prestige categories. What about mass category? I'll get to that in a second. But I think the.

Eurocentric. Ideals of beauty. The colonial hangover.

I think we like. Like you said. Anything that came from the west.

Was just way better. Way superior. India could never.

Because look. Look at our backyard. Look at how dirty everything is.

But I think. In. As time went by.

And in recent years. There's this pride. There's this nationalistic.

Indian pride. That I have seen in myself. I think when I first went abroad.

I myself would be like. Oh yeah. I've studied.

I have cousins from America. Or like I've studied. And now.

So proudly do I say. I'm from India. And I think it's been a conglomeration.

Of so many different. But still marry a white guy. And live in Netherlands.

But love I can't choose right. I happen to fall in love. With a white guy.

Kill me for that. You ran straight. You know what happened actually.

When I got married. I posted these beautiful. Wedding photos.

Some Indian men literally were like. Didn't we have enough men in India? I'm like guys. You don't choose.

Who you fall in love with. But no. Back to this story.

So. So that I think now. You know.

With everything that India is doing. Like the global south. Is where it's at.

India is the epicenter. Of beauty. In our industry.

But also in so many other things. It's where it's going to be. But we're still buying more.

Estee Lauder. We're not. But that's what we're arguing.

We're not. Majority. That's.

I feel like. As I think we'll get to that. Is that I think there's a shift.

There's a significant shift. In homegrown brands. Dominating.

Minimalist being a big one. Right. And something to be said about timing.

Can you put a percentage to this? Say. Five years ago. How much market share.

Did L'Oreal and Estee Lauder have? And how much do they have today? The belly of the market. Nikhil is still very mass. Right.

So mass and massage. So while L'Oreal Paris. And Maybelline play in that segment.

It is still a Lakme. A Lakme and a Maybelline that dominates. So Lakme is still sitting on the top.

Of the colour cosmetics charts. There's Lakme, Maybelline and MAC. But do you think people look at.

Minimalist as a nationalistic. Indian brand. Or it seemed foreign to begin with.

And they never. The good question. Spoke about their story.

They didn't do that many interviews. Nobody associated a name with the founder. So nobody.

I think all of that aside. I think what Minimalist did really well. And of course.

They're part of the Unilever portfolio. So I love them as well. But I think their products.

They really focused on good quality. They were I think one of the first. Brands who said.

Like even if you go to their labs. Or their manufacturing units. It's high quality ingredients.

High quality products. That I think was the first time. That consumers were like okay.

We are being shared transparency. They really let the kind of growth. In India on ingredient led.

And really educating the customer. Give me a tip here. I'm starting a brand.

I'm 20 years old or 25 years old. I have great quality. But how do I tell people.

I have great quality. Or how do I show them. How quickly do you want to scale? How much time do you have? As quickly as I can.

How much money do you have? Say 2 crore rupees. They started with that much. You know minimalist.

2 crores, 3 crores. They were very capital efficient. They didn't raise a lot.

They had their own manufacturing unit. That was a big up. But it doesn't cost a lot.

You know to put to manufacturing. It wasn't very capex intensive. You know there's a small lab.

See a lot of people can. Hack good quality. The question is.

How is the story told? How are you going to market? Yeah of course. Good quality is part one of the equation. Then you need a phenomenal.

Like marketing. Like of course with me. It was great that we had that trampoline jump.

To begin with. It is a content creator economy. Like it is content, content.

Like I tell my team this all the time. We're a product company. And a media company in one.

Like if we can do our content and media. That seems to be what everybody tells me today. Not just in your industry.

Yeah, yeah. You have to. Like that's the way.

Including him. He's a media company. As much as he's a product company.

No we're not a media company. But we do a lot of. Distribution of content.

Through channels that we own. As opposed to buying media off of inventory. Yeah, yeah.

As is Tira now? I think Tira is. We're also focusing highly on. I think content is one end.

But community is on the other right. And I think that you have to. You can be a great content creator.

But if you don't have a community. That is authentic. That has been built.

On a shared value. You're not really going to be able. To maximise it.

So I think that. What I would. You know.

I would start with is a hero product. You need to have one solid product. And you need to be able.

To solve a real problem. I think that's one thing. So even if it's good quality.

I think that's one. And then you can go and. Give me an example.

Hero product. My favourite example actually is. Mama Varthandas.

Because their hero products changed. But they were really. Onion something.

Onion something. Do you guys remember. What Mama Varth's first big hero product was.

When they were doing 5 crores a month. At a total level. Take a wild guess.

I love this. I know the onion hair. Onion one was like.

Maybe when they were doing 10-12 crores. Yes something for kids. Baby.

No but what. They were the best mosquito repellent for kids. Oh my god.

Outstanding product. Because it smelled good. And kids loved it.

I literally ordered it on Blinket yesterday. For kids? The same mosquito repellent Mama Varth. So Mama Varth was doing.

4-5 crores a month. And they were doing 3 crores of mosquito repellent. Yeah.

Good problem to solve. And then they went from that to the onion. And then of course.

I think also Mama Varth was the first wave. But I think what Bhakti is saying. About community right now.

No I'm giving an example of her right. Like Chumpy hair oil. She has that one product which.

And a lot of the story. Really works on that. So she picked that product.

She had a story which was. It's the community that made it. So I think like.

In today's day and age. You can copy product. Right.

You can copy. Branding. Marketing.

You can copy that. You cannot copy a community. It would take you so long.

To build the community. At a level that we've built. So like.

How do I build? How is it built? How do I build? How do you build? I'm 25. I'm starting. Like I want

all the questions.

That I will need. Answered to start tomorrow. You start small.

My first community event. Had 14 people. Is it by hosting events? It is by hosting events.

Is it more offline than online? But what if this founder. Does not want to be the face. Right.

I think there are people. Who may not want to be the face. Of their like.

We spoke one minimalist. You can still build the community. Yeah exactly.

But I think finding. The shared values. So finding other creators.

Who would have the same. Shared values as you. Or your brand.

And then really reaching out. To their communities. I think that's another way.

And a quicker way. Because there are people. Who will believe.

In the exact same thing. So if you take something. As simple as acne.

You know you're solving. For acne so. And you reach out.

To creators. Who've spoken about. Body image.

You reach out to creators. Who've spoken about. Changes that they've gone through.

You know who. Who talk about their journey. And or even experts right.

Who know how to solve this issue. And then reach out. To their communities.

Versus putting yourself. Out there as well that's. And offline helps.

But a lot can be done online as well. I think online is huge. I'm starting with 2 crore rupees.

I'm trying to build a community. Where are you playing first? That's the first question. I have some questions on the market.

So for me like. I always say. D to C I guess no? Yeah.

I think GTM will be. D to C will be interesting. But for example.

The market is by the way. Haircare is 7 to 8 billion. Skin is 6 billion.

But you're talking about also. Haircare as personal care. Yeah you're talking personal care.

So now this is. We play in the other bag. So haircare is 7 to 8 billion.

Of which majority is oil by the way. You're confusing us. You're talking about haircare and personal care.

Okay you said BPC right? Beauty and personal care. You're saying only beauty. No I want to know.

The break up of skin care. Make up, hair, fragrance. You said skin care right? So hair is 7 to 8 billion.

Of which majority is oil by the way. The rest is shampoo, conditioner. Parachute and.

Jhampi is coming for ya. Jhampi all of that right? So the. If you're looking at the.

Skin care, fragrance, makeup. How big is skin care? 6 to 7 billion. Skin care will be about 30 percent.

Okay. 25 to 30 percent. Color cosmetics.

3 billion. Makeup is also similarly 30 percent. 3 billion? Yeah.

You can take actually skin care as about 20 percent. Makeup as about 25 to 30 percent. Fragrance is actually significantly high.

30 percent. Particularly in the prestige section. Of what? Of the total market? I'm talking about the beauty market only.

Which is 40 to 45 percent. I think there's a little bit of confusion here. She keeps talking about beauty.

You talk about personal care. Exactly. So at a personal care level.

Hair is 7 to 8 billion. Which includes Vatika, Dabur, Amla. All of that.

And Jhampi. Makeup is 3. Skin care is 6 billion. Which includes by the way dove, ponds.

Everything. All the stuff that you were talking about. Moisturizers.

Glow and lovely. Everything. Okay.

Then beauty is 3 billion. Of which I think the. What is beauty? Beauty would be color cosmetics.

Now there will be some. Now I don't know where minimalists. Will either sit in skin care or beauty.

I think Nielsen will say. We'll lie in beauty. Because it's skin care.

That's 3 billion. And fragrances is 3 billion. Okay.

So beauty is growing faster than personal care. Which is everything FMCG. Other than these four categories.

And as I said. Even in hair care there's a difference. So there's certain.

And this is a forever. There is no right answer to how you segregate this. Because it's always going to be.

Every report has a different answer. And there's a few products that are great. Exactly.

Like you know the glow and lovely. We consider BPC. We wouldn't consider them in beauty pure.

But technically they're a moisturizer. You know what I mean? So there's a few. I guess those conglomerate brands.

And the ones who have really been like legacy brands. But mass. We consider them part of BPC.

The skin care. Like a minimalist wouldn't be BPC. That would be beauty.

Okay let me rephrase my question. Tell me which category is growing the fastest? Skin care. Fragrance.

Yes. Fragrance. I think fragrance is growing really fast.

I think fragrance is going to grow really fast. Fragrance is growing really fast. It's crazy.

And fast you mean like 15%? No I think. Skin care. Between.

So they're all growing between 10-13%. Because beauty is growing at a 10%. 10-11%.

If you were to start today. Start in a place where. There is a lot.

One is growth rate. The second is disruption. Yeah.

I agree with her. I think fragrance is seeing insane disruptions. 100%.

From last 15. Because why? If you look at the Indian fragrance market right now. There is one of two things.

You have the really expensive. Chanel. Tom Ford's.

Blah, blah, blah. Above 10,000. 15,000.

But originals. Then you have dupes. Which I don't know the brand names fully.

But they literally sell dupes of say. The best selling. Jio.

Aqua de Parma's. Blah, blah, blah. 599.

699. 799. Bella Vita.

Bella Vita. We do it. Exactly.

A lot of people do it now. And that's really mass. This entire segment.

Basically between 1,000 to 10,000. For the grabs. Yeah.

Like it's empty. Also there is a lot happening with fragrances. So there is something called.

Perfume wardrobeing that's happening. Yeah. Layering.

Layering. So earlier. So one is layering.

Second is perfume wardrobeing. So when I grew up. Different occasions.

Different moods. My dad and mom or I had like. One or two fragrances.

Or perfumes at any given time. Today. A 25 year old.

Bombay shaving company employee. Has. Is buying three new fragrances a month.

Yeah. So now you are buying. 10 ml.

15 ml. 20 ml SKUs. Packs of 4. Packs of 6. Packs of 8. So the entire.

Like it sells like Sonpapdi in Reliance. Literally. It's kind of kept.

Stacked. So people are putting. 3-4 things on at the same time.

No, no. That's a layering part. That's one trend.

That's layering. Where you like. Layer different.

To make a whole new fragrance. That's unique to you. Do you do that? Do I do that? Little bit.

Yeah. A little bit. Like you pick your favorite.

Like Jo Malone. You pick your favorite. Like Tom Ford.

And mix it. Then it's like your fragrance. And it's also different on you.

That's Shah Rukh Khan's head no? It was. Sorry I interrupted you. No I said it's also different on you.

Because everyone has a different. You know smell that they have. A particular one.

But what he's talking about. Is fragrance wardrobeing. Where now also for every mood.

Oh wow. For every mood. Like date night.

I want this fragrance. At work me. Me wants this fragrance.

Like evening. Chilling with my girlfriends. I want this fragrance.

So you have like a different mood. Also on the go right? You're carrying it in your bag. On the go yeah.

On the go refillables. I also think in fragrance. One more thing that's really.

Exploding is the. Like the cleanness of ingredients. Because I think for so long.

Beauty in general. People are becoming more conscious of ingredients. And how clean they are.

But in fragrance specifically. Under the name parfum. Or fragrance in your inky list.

Inky list is the. How do I explain inky list? The percentage of all your ingredients. Inky list is like the you know.

The thing that you have to write. On your label. All the regulatory ingredients.

So with perfume. You can literally just say parfum. And get away with it.

But what people have found out. Is that there's a lot of. Endocrine disrupting ingredients.

Like phthalates and this that. Within perfumes. That get in.

That people have been selling for so long. And a lot of the infertility rates. And all of that stuff is increasing.

Because of these phthalates. That people want clean ingredients. So clean fragrance.

Another huge trend. Thank you. In India I think.

By clean fragrance. You mean like vanilla. Cherry something.

That's a. No. Clean means. Chemical.

The chemically like phthalates. I think Nikhil you'll need. A whole day with that.

Vanilla and cherry. Nikhil vanilla and cherry is gourmand. Yeah gourmand.

That's like you want to eat that thing. That's a micro trend. Okay clean you mean like.

It won't harm you. Ingredients. The purity of the ingredients.

The percentage of ingredients. Transparency. Give me an example.

Of a perfume brand. Which does very clean. In India.

I don't know. In the west. There is Josie Maran.

It's this brand. Like body care brand. That now have done.

This really strong movement. On their no alcohol. As a base.

Which is what majority. Of fragrances have. Reduce the alcohol.

Because it's like drying. For your skin and hair. And their entire fragrance.

Is 100% natural. As in essential oil fragrances. And do they last as long? It doesn't.

It doesn't last as long. Because India is a hot country. It wears off.

The issue with Indian. Longevity of fragrances. Is that the western climate.

Is very different. From the Indian ones. Yeah it is.

So we. Yeah for Indian consumers. The number one concern is.

So that won't work in India. Long lasting. And that's why they like.

Stronger fragrance. Fragrances that have. A lot more scent.

Right like. The concentration. Of edipa farms.

Exactly. It has to be. Significantly higher.

They like strong smelling. Perfumes versus. But even this.

The gourmand fragrances. Is a two year old trend. So you'll see vanilla.

Croissant. Like all the big. That's working.

Yeah pistachio. Today Fragonard got funded. Sol de Janeiro.

Is the biggest brand. In beauty right now. It's all gourmand fragrances.

Every single one of them. Is you just smell it. And you want to like.

Eat it. I actually use perfumes like that. Like I have coriander.

Coriander is a good one. Good note. And that's another one.

Like now everything in beauty. Is all about food. If you see like.

That's such a big thing. That's happening that. It's like if you can eat it.

You can put it on your face as well. But that's a big trend. Whether it's on content.

Whether it's on color. Whether it's on marketing. Storytelling.

It's all about like you know. Cherry was the big trend. If you think of it psychologically.

Food hits such a nice place. In your brain. Like anything that has that.

Donuts or like our lip balm. Like one of our lip balm flavors. Is glazed jalebi.

Yeah. You know and it does. Insanely well.

It's because. You get this happy emotion. Subconsciously with jalebi.

You're like. Oh I'm going to put this in my lip balm. And lip is like a tasting.

It's. Also it's nostalgic right. Yeah.

So mango bite for example. Is now like a fragrance. That people are like.

Really looking for. Keyword searches for mango bite. You make that? No we don't make it.

You make mango bite fragrances. We don't yet. There's a pistachio.

Pistachio gelato. Pistachio gelato. Like Kayali has.

These fragrances. Kayali. It's by Mona Khatun.

It's a. Dubai based. Dubai based brand. And she has done.

All. Like she has really caught on. To the gourmand trend.

Pistachio. I saw someone else also have a. Pistachio gelato. Matcha.

Matcha. Everyone's doing matcha now. That smells bad.

No. But they make it smell good. They can make it smell good.

They can make it smell good. Good and bad is so subjective. Mochi.

Mochi. But yeah fragrance is going to. I think it.

Who is going to make the first. Laddu fragrance. Yeah besan ka laddu.

Like a nostalgia. Okay I'm going to. Summarise a bit of what you said.

You said the category. Overall is about 21 billion. Skincare 6. Makeup 3. Hair 7. Fragrance 3. Fastest growing is.

Skincare and fragrance. Yeah. Making deals with salons.

When you're starting a brand. Might be a good idea. Old products.

For hair care. For hair care. Yeah that's.

And professional hair care right. If you're. Looking to work with.

With professional. Grade products. So you need to.

Be able to call your brand. A professional brand. To be.

Actually be able to work with them. Old products made cooler. Nostalgia sells.

You said western. Better. Still sells.

But the trend is shifting. Shifting faster in premium and prestige. And slower in mass.

Mass is below 1000. Premium is 1000. Prestige is 2300.

Yeah. But I wanted to ask you a little bit. Sorry sorry.

Complete your thought. I did have a. All product companies are media companies. You need to run a media company.

If you want to sell a product. And community. Community.

You said community. But we didn't finish the thought. On.

You hinted it offline. Might be better than online. Or you need to have offline.

No I don't think so. And then we moved on to influencers. Okay we can.

We can go back to community. So I think. Community like.

Again what Bhakti said. It's a buzzword today. Everybody's like.

Community. Community. But I think.

I can only speak for us. But at IndieWorld. Everything we do.

Starts and ends with community. And I mean in it. Every aspect.

Like before we launched the brand. We had surveys. That were written by 16000.

Of my like followers. That really said everything. I had 13 focus groups.

Before the brand even existed. Asking them. What do you care about? What is your skin care concerns? What is it not in the market? Like you know.

Really figuring it out. Even in our bio till today. It says.

Co-created by you. So that is pre-brand launch. Once the brand launched.

You know we really interact. Like even the way. Our customer service is done.

It's not like a. Oh order misplaced. Okay here's your number. Go figure it out.

Like we really genuinely. Talk to them like. We'd say educated bestie.

Like you are their bestie. You talk to them. You keep the conversation going.

It's not just like. Finish order done. And so in every.

Aspect of IndeWild. Community is infused. It almost sounds like.

You're saying. Listen to your followers. And speak to them constantly.

Exactly. Is that community? Because I don't know what. Community is sounding like.

Spirituality to me. I don't think it's about. We all mean different things.

I think it's in. It's everything together. What's the best community? Who runs the best community? Take his example.

It is about like. There is a whole community. Of people who.

Like to take care. Of their beards. It's a small one.

But there is a whole community. That looks at it. As self-care versus.

Just looking at it. As you know. Something you have to do.

On a day-to-day level. Now that community. Is very different from.

People who use the products. As personal grooming products. They actually.

And I have a friend in London. Who really takes. Who has a three.

Three to four step. Grooming routine for his beard. He lives in London.

So he has a Turkish barber. Who he goes to every month. To take care of his beard.

And he. It's his ritual. And it's his self-care ritual.

Right? And now there may be. I suspect Chantanu is a bit like that. Sorry? No, I said I suspect.

You might be a bit like that. You have your barber. Who does everything.

And stuff like that. Yeah, yeah. So we have a group.

Whole group of barbers. Who kind of work with us. And that's.

That is exactly a community. But so. Is that a community.

Or a group of people. Who have something in common? No. Because community also.

Talk to each other right? How do you translate that. Into a community? Yeah, so it's. Because they have a shared value.

Right? So I think. If I have to simplify. What a community is.

It is a group of people. Who have certain shared values. That they can come together.

And speak about. So as I said. If you have acne concerns.

That's a you know. That's a community. And you may have.

A micro community in that. Saying you know. I'm 15 years old.

And then there's. These young teenage. You know like.

I've just grown out of. Or mums for example. You know I have.

I have two nieces. And they're now. 11 you know.

In that 11 to 13 age bracket. And they're the most. Impressionable age group now.

And they're also the most exposed. I don't think. When I was 11 or 12.

I really cared about skin care. My mum just said. Wash your face.

And that's about it. They know every single brand. That's trending.

Whenever they go to a t-rex store. My nieces will be like. Oh we saw that you launched.

You launched Fenty. You launched that brand. They know everything.

They told me like. Oh why don't you have this brand. They know.

It's a lot more. So there's exposure. But with that.

Comes a lot more pressure as well. Right now. Their mums.

Are a community. Because they're trying to. Figure out.

How can. What like my sister. Is always asking me.

Listen what can I use. You know if. She's having an acne breakout.

So. I think also what. What happens with community is.

If. When you're truly. A community of a brand.

You have a choice. You could go to any other brand. Like they could buy hair oil.

From any other brand. But the fact that they. Choose to come back.

To Indie World. Every time. That to me is a community.

And how you make it. I mean. I leave it to the creative.

Lens of the teams as well. So is community an emotion? Yes. It's definitely an emotion.

So you pick one emotion. Stay consistent. Then you listen.

And speak to your followers. While reiterating that emotion. Yeah.

And you're the custodian of the emotion. Yeah. How do I pick what emotion.

For my community. That's a very good question. That's a very.

I think you. You. Have done six.

Seven years of community building. Followed by. Brand building on the back of the.

Correct. So what is that emotion. For Indie World.

For example. Is it you? Are you the emotion? No. I think it's bigger than me.

I think that. The real emotion of an Indie World. Hot girl.

Huh? What did you say? Hot girl. Is that. I mean that could be an emotion.

It could. It could. Absolutely.

Identity. Vulnerability. Like I think.

Our communities. Real thing. Honestly.

I think in. There's pride. Definitely.

There's pride. Like Indie World. Being that first.

Global Indian brand. There's that pride to it. Like Hamara.

Are you selling. Patriotism? Yes. You have.

Definitely. There's. In Indie World.

Is purely a very proud. Of our culture brand. Is that working more.

Patriotism is selling. Oh for sure. Especially if the west.

Is also like. Wow. Chumpy.

Wow. Indie World. Then India is like.

Well. Are chumpy? Yeah. Like.

Are Indie World. And so I think. There's definitely.

Pride and. Patriotism there. But there's also this.

There is indeed. That cool girl effect. What you said.

Like. Indie World users. Are certain type.

Like road. Is a great example. Of that as well.

If you. Use road. Some consciously.

You're like. I'm part of the. It girl.

I'm an it girl. Because I use road. And how do I show that.

The first few. Content. Community members.

I have. Have to be good looking. Girls as well.

Not good looking. Necessarily. It's more.

What is a confident girl. It's. It's confidence.

It's. You're dressed well. You're sure of yourself.

Like. It doesn't have to. Necessarily be.

Hot. But it can also be. Imperfectly beautiful.

It's also lifestyle. Right. You.

You can. You talk about. The lifestyle.

That comes with. Being the it girl. So.

My circle of friends. My. You know.

Buying into. The wellness. I go to.

My Sunday. Matcha. With my pilates.

My athleisure. You're depicting affluence. By making it about.

Matcha. Yes. Right.

So. Affluence and identity. So.

Let's do this. Thought experiment. With your company.

Of two crores. You know you're. Going to build a brand.

And. He hasn't said. If it's women or men's yet.

It's women's. Okay. Okay.

I don't want to build. For. He's like.

He's like. He's too slow. Growing for me.

I wouldn't. But if you're. Going to build fragrances.

Are you building a fragrance. Then. The world is moving.

Towards unisex by the way. Gourmand fragrances. I mean.

I want you to tell me. I think gourmand. I think it can be.

For every mood right. So you can have. A whole variety of fragrances.

I think. What you would pick. Is a hook.

Like for example. Jo Malone is based. On these beautiful.

Ingredient stories. And they really. Really present it.

So well. Okay let's say. Nikhil's fragrance company.

Yeah. Actually don't say Nikhil. Because I probably.

Have a community. Let's say. What the fragrance.

Huh? What the fragrance. What the fragrance. What the also has a community.

That's the whole thing. Let's say. My name is Dilip.

And I'm building a perfume company. First question. What is your emotion.

That you want to sell. I'm 25 years old. I live in Bangalore.

You have two crore rupees. I have two crore rupees. That I borrowed.

I spent. The last many years of my life. Going to an engineering college.

But today AI has come. And I'm feeling very. Irrelevant.

Obsolete and irrelevant. First question. What's your why? Yeah.

What's the white space? What's my why. A fragrance company. Why are you.

Engineer at 25. Wanting to build a fragrance company. It's a very good question.

Because there are many reasons. Why people are doing it. Because I. Go to an engineering college.

In South Bangalore. I used to go. And people smell really bad.

And I want to change this. Excellent. I actually really like that.

That's a good point. That's a very good start. And why do they smell bad? Because.

They don't use fragrance. They probably do. You're smelling them in the evening.

I'm smelling. Sweat. In India.

We have it. We've done it for you. Your brand is going to be.

India's premium brand. Focused on a technology. That changes sweat.

That the sweat stink. Can be altered. Or differentiated.

Like a odor fix technology. That you put. As your proprietary ingredient.

Within your fragrances. But you only have two claws. To do all of this.

So I would. I would. You can find the ingredient.

And then I'll come to you guys. And raise some money. So while you have a problem.

I would say. Okay there may be. Two or three or four companies.

Already doing what you're doing. So I think. Yes that's your problem.

But. I like that idea. You know.

How would you kind of. Solve the white space. But I think having a why.

Is very very powerful. In storytelling. And like in being authentic.

And real you know. Like if you just make a business. Because like.

White space. Money. No I'm coming from.

A very like. Very. Practical mindset as well.

Because. While you have the storytelling. I think a lot of brands.

Also fail. Because they have storytelling. They have.

They have all of these other things. And they don't have this. Yeah.

So I'm here. I've figured. That why is people around me.

Smell horrible. They don't use perfumes. Or maybe they do.

But it's not working. Deepa suggested that. Public service.

We create a. Order fix technology. It could go huge. Maybe.

You're an engineering student. Who's never. Who doesn't want to stink.

But who's never been seen. Right. Can I market it.

With the story of. Do it for me. Not for you.

And you put on the perfume. Absolutely not. You cannot do that.

You can't market. You will not build a community. You will lose it.

Marketing technique. Which is also very out there. There is a market for it.

Okay I'm on Instagram. If he's tongue in cheek about it. Yeah.

There's so many brands. I'm on Instagram. I have 445 followers.

Okay. Actually Bhakti. I like that idea.

Be tongue in cheek sarcastic. Saying you stink. Nobody's ever told you.

You stink. So this is my brand for you. The person who people.

Don't say you stink. And all of us in the humidity. Sweat and stink.

Right. And if you would. You always want to.

Tell that one friend. Listen here. Here's my perfume.

Use it. But you don't have the heart to. Yeah.

So now this brand. Should I call my perfume. Stench.

Call them what? Call my perfume. If you're going to be a tongue in cheek. Branding.

Overall. You can't break. Category codes so much.

You want it to be positively. Reinforcing in some way. Right.

Like oh. I'm going to use this. Yeah.

Stench is a bit far. Every perfume. And deodorant.

And fragrance. I call it gutter. You can.

It's a big risk. It's a risk. Dilip should not take.

Stick to FinTech. I'm glad this is. On paper.

I think Nikhil can take that risk. Dilip should not. So Dilip should I think.

Follow category codes. And I'm definitely not listing it on Teera. No.

You wouldn't list it. If there was a perfume called Stench. If people asked for it.

So beauty is about. Making people feel. Feeling.

Good. About themselves. But everybody is doing that.

But again it's about. That's why your marketing. Can be tongue in cheek.

Like your content. Can be tongue in cheek. That can be a bit sarcastic.

That can be funny. Why would you call it gutter or stench. Yeah don't do that.

That's not what the product is no. But then you're saying the opposite. Of what your product is doing.

And that's the first thing. That people see right. Like that's the first.

Relation they make. What's the name of your product. Or what's the story you're telling.

Okay so what do I call. Anything else. Like something positive.

I got you. So for example. But Nikhil.

Let's take it. Take it a step back. What are the big trends.

Like one is gourmand. Second is. Oudh.

Yeah. Oudh is huge. Oudh is big.

Third is there is. Kanoj is now the Mecca of fragrances. So Dilip should go to Kanoj.

What is Kanoj? Kanoj is this little place in. It's like the grass of India. It's like this perfume.

You like that wet sand smell. Are you talking. No no no.

It's a place. Perfumeries. Where they make perfumes.

There are perfumers there. Right. Who like in the houses.

Where is this place? Kanoj is UP I think. I'm going to write down. Go to Kanoj.

Kanoj. K-A-N-N-A-U-J. Whatever.

Your trip. I think also going back to. What Deepa said about nostalgia.

There are so many beautiful. Indian inspired. You know fragrances that.

Are native to India. And that's a big trend. That's you know.

Picking up now. And people are kind of also. Giving that.

You know alluding to. Indian fragrances as well right. Like jasmine is.

So powerful. But it's. It's never found that rooting.

We've never kind of. Overly commercialized it. From a beauty perspective.

The craziest thing. Chanel number five. Everybody knows Chanel number five.

Their two main keynotes. Is from India. It's the jasmine and the rose.

From India. Like in their documentary. They literally showcase like.

Oh the Indian jasmanica. And la la la. It's literally from India.

And a French brand has used it. For centuries now. And yeah.

Time to take ownership. I also feel like. The big trend in fragrances.

That there is gender neutrality. Happening there. Like.

Like. Yeah. People are.

It's the strong fragrances. My husband and I share fragrances. Yeah.

Very easily. We go fragrance shopping together. Actually.

Fruit is becoming very common. No wonder Tejit smells feminine. I don't only wear feminine fragrances.

Then also to the whole. Layering bit right. So you can have a floral fragrance.

And then pair it with something. Extremely musky. Then you have a fragrance.

That's not too. Feminine. But just enough that.

You like it. And it's. It's masculine on your spectrum.

Or on. There's a spectrum in fragrance. But I think.

There will always be a differentiation. Between like men and women. I take issue of this layering thing.

I feel like. So brands themselves by the way. Now sell.

Perfumes layered together. Why do you find that an issue? I'm paying a brand. For their taste.

For their nose to do the job. Yeah. Why do I pay.

Chanel's perfumer. Or gourmand. Or whatever he's called.

Money. For his taste. And his nose.

And then I take it. And try to make it my own. But it's like you're saying.

That you'll buy all your clothes. From the same brand. No.

I will not go to say. Tom Ford. And say okay.

Now stitch a flower over here. And then cut this part off. I think it's just creativity.

It's about self expression. Individuality. It's like yeah.

Self expression. Minimalist's first brand. Actually this whole.

You remember that right? Minimalist's first brand was. These guys said. You tell me all the ingredients you want.

And all the stuff you want done. And we'll put it together. And give you a personalized shampoo.

Or a personalized body wash. That happens in the US a lot. Like it may not be.

Everything you want. But in skin care. They will create a. Questionnaire and all that yeah.

Questionnaire. You know. Basis your skin time.

How does that business model work though? Very hard. I've tried that. It's a pain in the ass.

It's crazy. I mean your supply chain. Just goes for a toss.

But I think that. People have tried it right? Hyper personalized skin care. So that's there now.

Because you know. We were talking about. How beauty has been through those phases.

Beauty is in this. Self expression phase. So while it's a shared value.

Community is also driving beauty. It's still you. There is a you and an us.

And the you part of you. Is driving all of these movements. I think we look over complicated.

The layering part. Can actually be a part of your offering. Because in fragrances.

It's a lot easier. It's much easier. To mix fragrances together.

But I'm a 25 year old guy. I've lost my job. I'm thinking what to do in life.

I don't want to have 10 bottles. And I'm layering. But you're upselling.

Are you doing it though? You're confusing. Who the customer is. You're cross selling.

I'm selling to people like. Are you selling for yourself? Or to women? We started off saying

women. So then why do you keep.

Thinking of Dilpreet. Dilpreet. What do you call it? Dilpreet.

No but tell me. You want to build a fragrance brand. And your issue is that.

You don't want them to go. To like 10 fragrances. And buy Bella Vita ka ye.

Or you know. No I don't want that. But you can yourself.

You can do it. You can. You sell it to the consumer.

Saying hey. You take this fragrance. Great you like it.

On its own. Amazing. But you take this.

Plus this. And now you've got a fragrance. Specially for you.

And I'm telling you. How to create it. So.

You remember the big moment. In fragrance no. The big aha moment.

In layering. You know when it happened. I don't.

It was an Instagram reel. Which had 20 Bollywood. Actresses saying.

I just love. How Shah Rukh Khan smells. He will.

He will smoke. But he smells amazing. As Kareena Kapoor.

And Priyanka Chopra. And Katrina. All the women.

Who men. Aspired to like. Date someone like her.

Or marry someone like her. Saying. This dude smells so good.

And then there's a separate video. Of Shah Rukh Khan saying. I layered two fragrances.

Diptyque something. And something something. And then.

There are 20 on Dilips in India. Who combined these two fragrances. Made a skew.

And just sold it on Myntra. You know what he does? He doesn't spray perfume on himself. He takes his jacket.

Holds it like this. And he sprays. Like 20 times.

How do you know that? Because I've seen him do it. Some people also spray. And walk into it.

Yeah. That's like. You do it.

And then. Does any of that make a difference? I'm not still selling this guys. Like Dilip has no business.

Going right now. You need to believe Dilip. You need to.

It's not working out. Dilip is not delusional enough. To be an entrepreneur.

Because you want to do fragrances. But you don't want to do the layering bit. Yeah.

Okay fair. That's fine. You don't need to do the layering.

Okay first thing. I'm building for the mass premium. Or prestige category.

I think three digit price point. I would say that. That entry premium.

Because there's a great segment. What price am I selling it? Above thousand. Yeah.

But below. But below 2000. I think.

Because there are so many. Because there is. You are very innocent.

Yeah. I think there are too many players. Under thousand.

I would say. Between the thousand to 2000. Thousand to 2000.

Is empty. It won't be built. How big.

How big. Sorry. Can I talk in Hindi? Yeah.

How big do you want the business to be? 500 crores. That's it. That's the upper limit.

Then you can do. I think that can be. This can be much bigger.

With a thousand. Zara is doing fragrances. At a thousand rupees.

I'm just saying. Entry price point. That becomes entry price point.

Because anything under that. Is too mass. My view is.

You should be able to give value. And aspiration. You nailed it.

But today. When you are looking at a fragrance. That is a Dior.

Or a Chanel. Or even lower. Right.

Everyone wants to aspire there. So when you are talking about fragrance. You want to also make

it.

A little bit more aspirational. So you can start small. So you can say okay.

I'll have a 50 ml at thousand. And then maybe a 30 ml. At 400 or 500 rupees.

If you want to give them. Good quality perfume. If you look at a 599, 499.

You want an 80% margin. I was thinking more 999. Okay 9. That is a thousand.

That's a thousand. But not 1000 to 2000. She told me 999 is a very nice price point.

But even that. 80% margin. Then like.

The quality of ingredients. You are going to have. Are not going to be as good.

As the quality of ingredients. That a proper perfume would have. And this is very true.

In a market like. Clean. Beauty.

Clean fragrance. No just. That's the challenge.

Going to this point of margin. And everything. As opposed to order.

The 200 dollar product. Versus the 20 dollar product. There is a big difference.

How much will it cost? 350 rupees. Significantly. Because of the quality of ingredients.

So this is one industry. Where like. You know.

Particularly in the efficacy of. But if he doesn't care about that. So.

It doesn't mean that. You won't get the same. You won't get the same results.

But there is. There is a difference. In selling.

You're not selling the same thing. At 20 dollars and 200 dollars. The results can be the same.

Because you're using. Different kinds of ingredients. But there.

In an industry like beauty. Yes there is markup. There is margin.

Perfumes are like bottled water. There's no difference. Between 200 dollars and 2 dollars.

Huge difference. In just. If you would go to.

Don't they operate at 90 percent margins? Yeah they do. So nobody is spending. More than like 50 bucks.

In making the product. But packaging. Makes a big difference.

Glass versus plastic. I'm talking about quality of product. It does.

It does. Like there's a weight of oil. If you use pure saffron oil.

Versus if you use. Like a synthetic saffron oil. How much will it cost me.

To make a 100 ml perfume. With pure good. Clean ingredients.

Less than 1000. I can make it in 500-600. Okay none of us.

Have a fragrance brand. So we can't really. Give you that much detail.

And we won't be like accurate. Absolutely accurate about it. Yeah.

We just launched. A 999 fragrance. Oh he does have.

Okay. You can give him details. We just launched like a week back.

Under which brand? Bombay Shaving Company. So it's called. Toxic Fruit and Little Beach.

By Bombay Shaving Company. You call your fragrance toxic? Fruit. Oh like the forbidden fruit.

And Little Beach. So it's kind of rebellious. It's like Bombay Shaving Company.

In a way. At 999. So it's a big price point for us.

Online or offline? Both. It's doing good? Omnichannel. Start is good.

We're at 100 DRR now. 100 days of sales. It's good.

So then. People will try. Is that a non-negotiable? Omnichannel? Oh yeah.

I think yeah. Today Omnichannel. If you want to grow at scale.

Omnichannel is the way to go. And that's where like. Multi-brand retailers like us come in.

Right? Because if you're talking about. A D to C brand. Yes.

You can start your own website. But I already have captive audience. Right? I already have the customers.

I had an idea actually. There's a whole. For Dilip or for me? For Dilip.

You. We were thinking about community. And like for example.

There's a huge opportunity. To build out the frag head. Community of India.

Explain. I don't even know what that means. Like sneaker heads.

Like sneaker heads. But frag heads are people who understand. So they're called noses.

So if you're a nose. You can distinguish between multiple notes. And there is like.

In a group of five friends. The nose has become like this. Status symbol that you are.

It's like a good wine taster. In a group of people who like wine. For example.

Like a sneaker head is cool. A sommelier is cool. I don't know what frag head is.

So you're saying build it up. Build it up. Make it cool.

That becomes a common purpose for. Like how we made the Chumpy cool. And that's a community.

Then it's a community. Now you can also make. Insane content about this community.

Like you get frag heads into your pod. Or whatever. Your Bangalore home.

I can go around smelling celebrities. And making expressions. Have smelling events.

Bring them together. Let them create their own. Signature perfume.

And then you can have food. Associated with it. Can I tell you a very funny story? So I rented this place.

Some time ago. And I've had a few house managers. Along the way.

One of them. For three months of the year. Smells like dead fish.

One of them joined. I was not in town. I spent like a week.

A month here. One of them joined. And quit.

Even before he could ever meet me. And he said. This area smells so bad.

That he can't survive. So smell is a big. He had a very strong nose then.

So smell is a problem. But good smell is not. Equally proportional.

As an incentive to do a trigger. To be a trigger event. No it is.

In what way? Like I feel like. I can sell fear. Around bad smell.

Much more than I can sell. The incentive of good smell. No, no, no, no.

I totally disagree with that. Because good smell triggers. Again we spoke about emotion.

It triggers that emotion in you. It triggers a memory. It triggers something.

It takes you back to some. Some moment in your life. It triggers a memory.

The same way makeup. Like when women put it on. They feel almost like this.

More confident versions of themselves. Perfume has the power to do that too. Like the second you smell.

A incredible perfume. Like I can feel. Suddenly more.

Stronger in myself. Or like you can. Armor yourself with something.

Or you feel more sophisticated. Or you feel more. It's like another.

Like putting on clothes. Sensual as well. Yeah it's like another.

Part of your identity. You can put on. Big time.

It's happening a lot. Some people have the same fragrance. For many years.

Like Old Spice. My dad. Like forever.

That was that generation. I love everything. That smells like a barbershop.

Why doesn't Dilip make. Old Spice in a new way. Nostalgia plus.

A smell that everyone remembers. Spicy. Layer it up right.

Yeah. I think it's a fantastic idea. Old Spice.

And throwing a cool water. Oh wait for this. Whiskey smoke.

Or Old Spice plus like. Danish. He's like.

That could work. Old Spice with a vegetable. Or like.

No I think bakery. Old Spice. So unsexy.

So quickly. I think we're never going to want to. Cabbage create a fragrance brand.

Old Spice Jalebi. Yeah. I think that'll do really well.

You can make an entire. Old Spice and sweet is like. A bath and body range as well.

With that. I think step one for you. Is to find a good nose.

Yeah. Cabbage and Old Spice. And I don't think you can lead them to it.

No you can develop it I think. No I don't think he can lead the nose. He cannot develop it.

But your bathroom has some really nice fragrances by the way. That doesn't mean he has a good nose. I'm assuming you're.

You're pretty unbiased. Had some say on what's there. I've had no say on anything.

In life. Pretty much. But.

Let's say Old Spice. What did we say with? Danish pastry I think. Old Spice.

With bakery. With bakery or Jalebi. Jalebis are not sexy.

Cheesecake. Jalebis are sexy. Old Spice with leather.

You'll be amazed Nikhil how much. Do you want to make it for men or women? Women. Women.

Old Spice with then something gourmand yeah. Vanilla. Vanilla.

Vanilla. We'll have men for that. We'll have men take over for that.

Yeah. I like vanilla smelling perfumes. I buy them all the time.

Vanilla is one of the most popular scent profiles. I don't know. I don't know if this is selling.

But we'll come back to this okay. The community offline helps. Online also helps.

Offline I think has an impact which is exponential in nature. I don't know why with most communities I've found that. When I bring a bunch of people together who see each other physically and touch each other.

Touch each other. I think it kind of. Sound like a cult.

But if you're doing offline community events. Like making content around it and distributing it on. Yeah.

The fragmented community. There's a dual effect for that. And I agree patriotism is selling.

And Trump has four years left right. Three. Three and a half.

It'll sell more up until then. Is status affecting you? Big time. US.

You were asking only your first question was your share in business right. US used to be 60%. And in the last year.

Thanks to people like Tira. Our retail has grown 500% in India. And now India is 60% and US is 40.

So back then US was 40 and India was. US was 60 India was 40. Now it's flipped.

There's another thing that India has done. Where do you manufacture? I'm one of those really. Product obsessed people.

We go wherever the best manufacturing is. It's not my husband hates it. Because he does the ops and finance part.

You guys work together. We do. We're co-founders.

So where do you manufacture? So we manufacture like Chumpy is in India obviously. But like our lip balms are in Korea. Because I found the best lab there for it.

Eye cream is Japan. Again Indian ingredients. But manufactured in Japan.

The tariffs are hitting you but not at 50%. Every corner. Every side.

This might be an opportunity in itself. Make Indian products outside of India to beat tariffs. Yeah.

I'm. Sorry make Indian products where? Outside of India. Why? Make Indian products outside of India.

Because there is demand for Indian products. And you don't have to pay 50%. And sell them there.

Yeah. Yeah. For the American market.

I'm not suggesting that. It's a bad idea. Lot of no no.

Lot of Indian companies have now created US subsidiaries. Because of TikTok shop. Yeah.

Yeah. TikTok shop is huge. Huge.

A lot of people when I was researching this. Told me that. Instagram is content created by brands.

And TikTok is more UGC. Yes. That's.

I mean there is TikTokification happening of Instagram as well. But I don't think. I don't think it's managed to crack it.

Perfume talk yeah. Perfume talk yeah. Perfume talk.

Like TikTok. Every talk. Yeah.

Like in TikTok there is every talk. Skin talk. Hair talk.

Hair oiling talk. This talk. That talk.

Every talk. And. TikTok is.

Insane. I hope we get it to India soon. Nahi yaar.

But abhi aaya tha na. China India was shaking hands. Yaar I was.

I met a Unilever guy who heads China. So. We hear all these numbers no.

I was blown away. I don't know if you guys know this. Doyin.

Which is TikTok. Is 40% of retail. It has broken every marketing rule possible.

For one reason. Is because there is now so much content. For consumers.

They are doing. 4 hours of research before they buy a face wash. So now this whole thing.

Ki tum agar brand bana rahe ho. Toh tum ek hi message bataao. 10 saal tak ek.

It's gone out the window. Because I have to tell everything. But you're still buying more.

Than you would have bought. If not for TikTok. Consumption goes up.

But it becomes very noisy. Very noisy. So brands can't stand it.

But net-net good only na. But the question then is. Why doesn't TikTok.

Create their white label products. If they know what sells. And they can.

Influence it. Because that's not the game. They're playing in.

Like Amazon. Not making private labels. Eventually the Chinese companies.

Tend to do everything right. I don't think. I don't think they need to.

Like Amazon does that. Now they have TikTok shop. Where they keep a percentage.

Of every sale. Every brand does. So they're already making so much.

And ad sales on top of that. And shop sales. So like they have enough revenue.

Streams. But making globally relevant fragrances. Will be a good idea for Dilip.

Coming back to. Coming back to Dilip. You might be Dilip.

I think building from India. For the world. Is something that we have.

To start doing a lot more. Of what she does. What India World is doing.

100%. I think the world's ready. Like we've had.

Korean skincare. Beauty. Obviously explode in the world.

Japanese. Skincare. Beauty.

We've had fragrances from France. We've had skincare from France. Like it's all happened.

It's time. It's time for India. It's time for India.

And India World. And we've done. We've done.

Doing that. We've done. We've done right.

With Ayurveda and all. We've done a bunch of. Yeah but till the UK still.

Like if you look at Kama Forest. They're only in the UK. I feel like that's a big step.

From for a brand. To go outside of India. Have this stunning presence.

And for people. To kind of bench it on global. You know with global brands.

And you know. Take their names in the same breath. And I think.

We would have never imagined that. Like 10 years ago. And I think that just goes back.

To what you said. We would have done it. Pageotism.

Pride. Even 10 years ago. Like when I was growing up.

I would never imagine Sephora. The Sephora. Take an Indian brand.

Like India Wild. And build a global partnership. I mean Sephora America.

Is like the. The world cup of beauty. Like there's nothing bigger.

Than Sephora North America. And for them to be like. India Wild.

We want you to come launch with us. Is. Yeah.

And Ayurveda. And Indian beauty. For sure.

And we all celebrate. Huge. Hugely.

Like popular right now. You know the. Supermarket store.

Arowan right. In LA. So this time I went there.

You get $40 smoothies there by the way. I like going there. It's so good.

But it's expensive. But it's good. But if you look at their shelves.

Everything Shilajit. Shatavari. Turmeric.

Ashwagandha. Like. There is a craze.

In at least the wellness. Like kind of. Longevity.

Sea moss. Sea moss. Yeah but that's not Indian.

I'm focusing on the Indian one. That's the main thing in the store. I think it's a way of life right.

And I think that. To your point. When we were talking about.

What. What we got from the west right. I think now.

Indians are kind of. Understanding the. The.

Long standing traditions. And heritage that India comes with. And kind of.

We've always had it. I think we're just now. Extremely proud of it.

And. I think Indian beauty. Is a way of life.

Wellness. Yeah. You know Indian wellness.

Like with Ayurveda. Has really been like. Intricately woven into India.

For so long. That we ourselves. Didn't give it enough credit.

Like if you look at. Yoga. Meditation.

Breath work. Mindfulness. We've all had it.

It took the west. To be like. Scientifically prove it.

And now we're like. Oh my god. We should be.

Nervous system reset. Kapalbhati. You know like.

Do you think a high end. Boutique hotel. Like Aman.

With. Indian yoga. Breath work.

Turmeric. All of that will do well. It will.

Like insane. Insane. Insane.

I think Kapil is doing. A postcard in a way no. Like it's all about longevity.

Inward looking. I'm talking outside of India. And outside it will work.

Even better. Here's something in Bhutan. I think he's going outside now.

He wants to build the best hotel. A guy's like the longevity. But that's not so much around wellness.

Postcard is more. Take a home. Retained aesthetic.

Yeah exactly that. Clean. There's no yoga.

There's no breath work. There's no wellness. It's not.

Pivoted on wellness. I think the searches in the pandemic. For like.

Ingredients like ghee. Like all the fitness bros now. Cook in ghee.

You know. Cause like. Like the smoke point's really high.

And it's super healthy. Our dadi was like. Cook in ghee is the best.

And we never believed her. But now indeed. They're all getting scientifically backed.

And it's growing a lot. What about influence? I'm starting a brand. I have figured out.

Maybe how to make a deal with. Salons if it's in here. I figured out the old product.

I can bring back and sell nostalgia. I have added the Indian narrative to it. Patriotism.

I found the emotion. I've doubled down on the emotion. I talk to the people who follow me.

The few people. I listen and I speak to them often. And I figured out that.

I have one hero product. That I'm starting with. That product is let's say.

A moisturizer. For the lack of a better word. Omnichannel.

I'm on Tira. I'm in some physical stores. I'm selling online.

All of that. Now. I have come to a point.

Where I've realized that. All of this is only taking it so far. And I need to figure out my.

Influencing and marketing piece. How do I do that? Are you sure the product works? The hundred. The hero product question.

The hundred people. I'm speaking to right now are buying it. So repeat rates are 70-80 percent.

Then. Then I think. My view is.

My view has always been like that. Influencer. The best influencers are your current customers.

And the best. Not celebrities. Not early on no.

My view is just take the product. And start sending it to celebrities. And see who starts liking it.

Can I do that? Just send it to them. And they'll post it. Oh yeah.

Has a celebrity posted for you? Just by sending it to them? Plenty of times. Oh that's lovely. Who? Men.

Multiple. So we send it to Ranvijay. We send it to Ashwin.

We send it to. Who's Ashwin? The off spinner. The Indian cricketer.

If she's asking who. There's a problem with the celebrity. No.

It's a cricketer. It's a different demographic. Legend cricketer.

Hmm. When we launched the head shaver. We had sent it to Raghu and Rajeev.

They posted? Aha. Raghu, Rajeev. In fact.

Just on their legends. Yeah. We handed a note on the founder.

Wow. Handed a note on the founder. Someone from the team getting in touch.

For the address. They said like. You'd have to make the effort.

To make the person feel special. Perhaps it was less. Cluttered then? Were you the first one? There's no head shaver.

With Ashwin it was with Trimmers. Yeah. With Ranvijay also it was Trimmers.

When did you start the brand? 2016. Okay. So it was a less cluttered market.

No? Which one? Trimmers? In like men grooming. Skin care in general. It was a smaller market.

But it was getting cluttered quickly. There were like some. Legacy is similar.

Legacy players. Tell me some conversion rates. How many celebrities did you send it to? And how many posted? What was the cost of that exercise? Till date we've probably sent.

10 to 12 thousand. Pre-samplers to micro influencers. Macro influencers.

Creators and then. Cricketers, actors, television etc. We've probably had 500 organic.

500 organic yeah. 5%. Is it more the product or your letter that is getting the trigger? It's a combination.

I think as I have also built a public profile. People also know that okay. This can be like a give and take thing.

And then the conversion has gone up as a brand. So they post and you repost in that case. Get stem distribution.

Post, repost, come on. But I don't have that as a new person. I don't see any celebrities.

I'm keeping quiet. Because I love influencer marketing. And topic like we do it very well.

But indeed if you're telling me. The person is starting with no following. It is a harder game indeed.

A lot of people like are. We send about per launch say 500 to 600. Influencer boxes for any launch.

50% post us. Because they're like Deepa will repost. Deepa will look at it.

Or I think that's a aspect. And second aspect I think is. IndieWild is such a like loved brand.

That they look forward to the PR box. Because every time a PR box is an experience. It's like and so for a young girl.

To get an amazing box. Where you open it and look super pretty. And the product is there.

Like they want to show the content. To their following as well. So it becomes like a content piece.

For them all together. So we have a really high organic. Like love and kind of push for.

Packages and gifting. But if I didn't have a following. I don't know it's a hard one.

I would say indeed you start with micros then. Start with nanos and micros. Who even if they

have 2000 or 5000 followers.

You start with them. And start building them into a community. That the words that we keep saying.

And then start from there. And then start leveling up slowly. And that's why I think that shared purpose.

Or value comes right. That you find those creators. Who align with your brand.

Who are the frag heads. Or they grow with you. Because I think that's the beauty of it.

Like you have maybe. If you don't have that much money right. You will have about 20 of them.

Versus and I truly believe. That the nanos and the micros. Get you a lot more traction.

Organic reach and conversion. Versus you know using mega influencers. You use mega influencers.

For the awareness. The problem with mega is. They are very used to getting paid.

Exactly. So because they are so used to getting paid. And they get 1000 packages a month.

From all the different brands in the world. For an unknown small brand. They are less likely to open it.

So it goes to waste. They charge a lot. And they charge a lot.

It's all brand collaboration. Paid brand collaboration. By the way Meta.

Instagram is now bigger than. WhatsApp in India on daily active. It's a crazy number.

Do you guys know this? No. Instagram like two weeks back. Has gone ahead of WhatsApp on daily active.

And creator partnerships are becoming big. The thing with micro influencers is. That A. They will do it for you.

Even if you are a small brand. With two expectations. One.

That. I might become a brand ambassador. I could get an influencer deal.

If I do a good piece of content to start with. Two. Is my friends will think.

That I am now getting paid for content. You start signalling. That you are an influencer also.

That's what I said. Like indeed. They feel like they can use this for content.

Like it becomes like. Oh brands work with me now. So if I am trying to build influence or marketing.

I should definitely send it to celebrities. Bottom up. Start with micro.

With the gift box should have a heartfelt. Handwritten letter. And I need to repost if they share.

Yes. And if it can be unique. Cherry on top.

Like not like every other box. That they are getting. But think of something outside the box.

Can you give it to them in a. In a. I don't know a tin box. Can you give it to them in a. With fresh flowers. Like is there something unique.

I was going to say that. If you have some element of storytelling. Yeah or a surprise and delight.

That goes far enough. And then you create that unboxing moment. So again.

You're telling the consumers. About the brand in that moment right. So again we were talking about that.

How do consumers interact for the first time. Through influencers in that moment. So you kind of think of that entire piece together.

Or they're unboxing the brand. They're seeing the brand for the first time. So that kind of.

Is as much for the consumer. As for the creator. Yeah.

So you think of it that way as well. I also think sampling distribution. Is a huge opportunity.

Which we don't do well enough on. Explain. 100%.

Like for example. My favourite example of. Sampling distribution is uncle chips.

Uncle chips distributors would go with. Like big malas of uncle chips. Around their neck.

And go into a village. And the kids would like. Yeah kids would just come.

And he would feed a chip here. Feed a chip there suddenly. Kids are buying.

Moms are there. That is full gorilla marketing. I love it.

With fragrances. Like going into a college fest. For example.

With like a whole suitcase. Of your perfumeric innovations. Yourself smelling really great.

Would be great for them. What is the word you used for this? Sampling. Sampling.

Yeah sampling. You basically get a sachet of something. Or a trial.

Not even a trial pack. It's a small sampling. Sample that you can use.

For maybe 2 or 3 washes. Or 2 or 3 moisturising. You can also do it really well.

With a t-ra. Where you say. Hey t-ra.

I'm going to give you 100,000 samples. Put it in every order. Every time somebody buys.

That doesn't work. You don't think so? T-ra I don't know. But blinkets not work.

But the thing is. I think it really depends on. Who the customer is.

Who you are sending it to. Targeted. Is it correlated or not.

Is it going to the KitKat buyer or not. Everything. Repeats are just not there.

I think it works. If you do it correctly. It's great for even upselling.

So if you want to convert. A mass brand into a. You want to convert a consumer. Shopping in mass.

For hair care. To Mastige. Then you will send them.

That Mastige sample. And I will upsell them. You know they'll be like.

Especially if the product. Has been getting a lot of buzz. In social.

Exactly. And people are hesitant. To buying it.

Because say price or whatever. And then they get that sample. They're so happy.

Especially if it's a deluxe sample. And they get to try it. Once in their hair.

Or like try it on their face. 2-3 times. And they're like.

Oh I've been dying. Now I got this. Now I'm going to buy full size.

And that's where minis come in. In beauty. The mini and travel size.

Is just. It's a whole business on its own. And in fact.

This. A Bobby Brown area manager. Told me this that.

India is a mini capital of the world. Like global brands have produced. Their best sellers.

Particularly for India. Because they know that. India is a value market.

Value I don't mean that. We move from price consciousness. To saying that.

I will pay for the product. If I find value in it. So to cross that barrier.

They're like. Okay we'll give you a mini. You still pay for it.

After having sampled it. There is that. You know that bridge.

So you buy a mini. Of our best selling product. If you like it.

Then you will buy the full size. So they've built that bridge. Particularly to get you.

From a must-each to a premium brand. And you may not even move. Into the full size.

And you sell the mini. Or do you just give it away? You sell the mini. You sell it.

You sell it. So like Estee Lauder. Estee Lauder specifically.

Did the phenomenal mini job. With MAC. For India specifically.

They made their lipsticks. Lipstick in a mini form. It was like a tiny lipstick.

Killed it. And they're best selling shades. Not the you know.

Not the ones that don't. Don't sell too much. Same with it.

Moisture Surge. Minis. Everything is like.

Oh I want luxury. But give it to me. At an affordable price.

So I can try it. And then I'll buy the full thing. But it's the whole wardrobe thing right.

If I'm going to keep 30. I don't want 30 100 ml or whatever. I'm going to have 30.

Are you talking fragrance or skincare? Both I think. Skincare people wouldn't wardrobe. With color for example.

Ha makeup. Yeah. Makeup.

Yeah. Makeup. You want brown one.

For example. A mascara runs out. If you open it in six months.

You have to finish it. Or else you should not be using it. So I only buy mini mascaras.

Because I'm like okay great. I only use that much. So I will only buy a mini mascara.

Is that true for perfume? You shouldn't use it after six months? No. There is expired. It's a

perfume.

Expiry but it's. Yeah for perfumes. For mascaras it just clumps after.

Yeah mascaras for sure. I think supermarkets do this right well. I feel like the sampling works better in person.

When you give somebody something in person. At maybe a tita store or a supermarket. Yeah so we have a vending machine.

That when you enter. Even if you don't walk out with anything. That you purchased.

You walk out with a sample. Because you know we've made it. We've gamified it.

You you know you put in your number. And you know you your email address. And you select which sample you want for that.

You know you'll have fragrance sample. A skincare sample. And a makeup sample.

And you select which one you want. And we let you take one sample in two months. So if you every two months.

When you come to our store. You get something to take back. And we work with brands.

To really you know utilize this. To again for sampling. So again you've gamified it.

You've created a moment. And offline is all about experiences. So you've created that experience.

Two greatest sampling successes. From a brand standpoint. Was Lifebuoy at Kumbh Mela in Covid 2020 or 2021.

Where they gave Lifebuoy to everyone. Who was eating roti. So before you eat.

You use Lifebuoy. The second one was Paper Boat in Indigo Airlines. Paper Boat was built as a brand.

Again nostalgic taste. By distributing as samples on Indigo Airlines. And then it became something a part of the menu.

And then. This nostalgia keeps coming back. The more I think about it.

Paper Boat was about nostalgic flavors. I think you might be bang on with your Champi. Yeah.

Is that what it's called? Champi? Champi hair oil. Yeah. Even the name.

I had to fight in my team. They were like no. But like don't call it that.

We all have a bad connotation with it. I'm like no. It's gonna work.

Because it's a ritual. You're literally putting the name of what we all know. It's a household name.

On a bottle. It's gonna work. Could a brand of just minis work? Yes.

I think in the category or in fragrances. Yes I think so. Yeah.

Fragrances for sure yeah. But it's also expensive to make minis. That's true.

The margins are not as good. Yeah the margins are not great in minis. Because you have to make that much product.

And your packaging still costs the same. I actually was gonna ask you. From the limited knowledge that I have.

That you know it's. Brands don't like minis as much as consumers do. Correct.

That's true. I was actually gonna ask you whether. Sustainability is something Dilip cares about a lot.

Because that's another Gen Z trend. I don't think that's a trend right now. It was a trend yesterday.

It's a bare minimum. I think you have to care about it. But I don't know.

I think that again maybe. Do you think sustainability is also a little bit of affluence? Does something sell more because sustainable. Maybe in India not as much yet.

But I think again the Gen Z values. Starting to become more important. And for me as a founder.

I don't want to clutter the market more. Like if you look at even just. Sustainable in every measure they say.

You know our packaging is mostly glass. So it can be recycled better. We have six SKUs in three and a half years.

We're not in the business of building 200 SKUs. 300 SKUs. Clutter the market.

Like we really are like hero product strategy only. Talk to the consumers. What do they want? Build it for them.

And then really put all your marketing might in six SKUs. Instead of which one am I picking here. Like am I playing you know.

You're gambling then. So I think sustainability for me as a founder. Is very important.

Do you put it on every product? That we're sustainable. No. Because it's a given.

Like I don't need to scream about it. I agree with that. That's why I don't think putting sustainability will sell.

So I'll tell you where I'm coming from. The reason is I think today's Gen Z. Whether it comes to food or personal care. Actually cares about the product inside the bottle.

Not the bottle so much. They're way too smart for that. And if you make that a point of your communication.

You don't need to spend 30% of your cogs. On a glass bottle that looks great. You can get away with a product that is much cheaper.

It could be an idea for Dilip. Yeah. And then you actually focus all the money on the product inside.

It can be a plain black bottle. And my marketing can be not about the bottle. Yeah.

Like ordinary is all about that. You know have you seen those ordinary billboards. All over the place where they're like.

Ordinary eggs. Yeah people told us we should hire celebrities. But we put all our marketing money.

Into building the best product ever. They said make better packaging. But we put all the money into the formulations.

Not about the bottle is a good line. Do you think? Yeah. Yeah.

Yeah. Because fragrance is always. Dilip is starting to feel better.

Slowly. But for sustainability. I think the thought leaders.

Of the world today. Are moving away from sustainability. And hence I think it'll trickle down.

Permeate down to the consumer as well. If you hear a Trump talk about. Bring plastic straws back.

Drill baby drill. I was doing a. You mean you're saying it's going. The novelty around sustainability.

Has gone I think. It was really big two years ago. In my opinion.

I don't think so. You don't think so? I think the young consumers care. India for sure.

Globally I don't know. India for sure young consumers. Urban young affluent consumers will care.

They care. No. It'll be a differentiator.

I think if it were Deepa. Would have sustainable on her packaging. No because they know.

What a conscious brand I'm building. Like when I speak to. The content I make is about.

We are sustainable. We are vegan. But we're not screaming about it.

Because that's a no-brainer for us. You know being vegan. Being this.

Like table sticks. Cruelty free. Table sticks.

But it's also how we stand out. I feel like the word sustainability. Has been used around.

In very many ways. And people also have some amount of. Doubt around it.

That what is actually sustainable. So I think brands also. Do stay away from.

For the fear of getting called out. Because anything you say today. That's sustainable.

You will still get called out for it right. So I think there's a little bit. Of fear as well.

On what the consumer really believes. You stand for. So I think it's.

Kind of not being able to distill. Those sustainable values. What sustainability in beauty.

Really stands for. Like right now it's. If we talk about sustainability.

Technically it's less consumption right. But now there's refillable. So that's a step.

In the right direction. But is it 100% sustainable? No. But you're still kind of.

Again it's all about. Creating that lifestyle. So I think it's.

It's still about the lifestyle. I think being honest about that. I think also with.

Founders who are a little sustainable. Nobody can be all the way sustainable. Because then don't have a brand.

If you're going to be. Like be honest about. These are the areas.

We're working on our sustainability. These are areas. That we cannot yet.

Until we get scale. Until we can. You know the refillable program.

There's a way to do it. Exactly. Sometimes there's no way out.

Just be honest. I think that's the main thing. Because you said honest.

So many times. Like I am as far removed. An expert in this industry.

As anyone can be. But looking from afar. It feels like.

The sustainable organic. Natural movement. Happened when.

Was it Jessica Alba. Started the Honest Company. Which was.

Six, seven years ago. Long back. Ten years back.

Ten years ago. You could say so. Yeah.

I feel like. Guwani Paltrow. Yeah.

I feel like the wave. After that. Was the wave of actives.

Yeah. Yes. Which was.

Maybe a couple of years ago. And most companies. That I looked at.

Which did really well. Were companies. That caught on to a. Change in cycle.

Before the cycle changed. I think Minimalist. Was exactly in that spot.

So my question to you guys is. If the active cycle is midway. What comes next.

And what can I build. To catch on to the next cycle. Before the others come.

I don't think it's about sustainability. I think it's. I think the Gen Z. Younger consumers are actually.

What we are now starting to realize. Are skinimalists. Just give me what I need.

Don't give me next. Skin minimalism. Skin minimalism.

So just like. Minimalist is a classic. Just give me these three molecules.

I don't need the jazz around it. I don't need a 10 step skincare routine. If that is what they are thinking.

Why should I have three molecules. Why can't I have the combination of three. In a way which is effective.

That's what we do. That's what three molecules do. So like the whole 6 SKU thing.

I was talking about earlier. Our whole play was. We're not going to be a minimalist.

We're not going to be a plum. Or a mama earth. We're not going to do the whole thing.

Assortment yeah. We're going to do one serum. With 12 serums in it.

With an expert. Who does it for you. We're going to do one evening ritual.

For the mom on the go. For the college student. For the one who doesn't have time.

For a 12 step skincare routine. And it's very progressive actually. Yeah and we did this already.

Two and a half years ago. Where everybody was only buying. The 700 rupee vitamin C. From ordinary or this.

And I'm like wait. They're going to get there. Like at one point.

Because we saw it in the west as well. It was the ordinary that led the way. And then it was the drunk elephants.

It was the you to the people. All the other brands. That really brought them together.

That people are like okay. One that's it. I don't need anything else.

And this is moving even into makeup right. So you want. Skinification of makeup.

So anything to. You don't want to put anything. On your skin that harms it.

So skincare ingredients. In makeup products. And layered with an SPF.

So imagine that you're just putting. That one product on the go. So if I don't have time.

But I'm coming here. And I just have that one product. It should do the job.

Everything for me. It moisturizes my skin. It protects me from the sun.

And it allows me to have. A good amount of coverage. For my no makeup look.

It's. Like multi-purpose. Multi-active.

On the go. On the go. That's what the consumer wants.

Do you think the next wave. Could be that in my bathroom. I have three bottles.

One which says morning. One that says afternoon. One that says.

Afternoon what do you need for. Then two bottles. Two yeah.

Yeah. And sunscreen. So the two bottles.

Would be like your actives. Like your serums. The morning will have the sunscreen.

Okay fine. Then you're fine. You can put the sunscreen.

Together with it. Another big trend. In Gen Z. I think is also.

Around stress management. So skin care. Like skinification of hair.

For example. Or skin care. That helps you sleep better.

It's hugely. Like magnesium. Rolands are like.

Exploded. Helps you sleep better. Is that like a. Sleep well.

Something I mean. I could eat. The magnesium pill as well.

But yeah. So great. There's some studies.

Shown that the magnesium. Is absorbed by. Like skin better.

Then your gut. Takes it away or something. There were some studies.

I think people. Doctors would still say. You can do the pills.

I take the pills. But indeed magnesium lotion. Magnesium oil.

Because apparently. It gets into your bloodstream. More from.

Isn't that more. A magnesium thing. Than a skin care thing.

Where did magnesium. Come from. Two three years ago.

Nobody spoke about it. But for example. If you're building a fragrance brand.

A pillow fragrance. Would be a very critical. New age case.

Like a lavender. That helps you. I've had.

Like sleep fragrances. You never remember. To use them.

I don't feel like. It's a habit. It's not like.

Brushing your teeth. But you keep it on your bedside. It's just one of those products.

That's great to have. But you never use it. Every hotel gives it to you now.

But how often. Do you actually use it. That's very true.

One friend will use it. Or if you're a girlfriend. Like someone.

I also feel. We do. Because we don't use it.

We don't feel like. Others can see you use. No no.

Or there's some effect of it. You'll feel it yaar. You'll feel it.

You feel. With the lavender spray. You sleep better.

Oh magnesium is really improving. No no magnesium. Where do I go with a lavender spray.

Lavender spray. I don't know. But magnesium roll on.

Magnesium warms yaar. I'm using my morning serum. Whatever is in this one bottle.

Which has everything. That's the in their world. Vitamin C. But then you still need a moisturizer.

It has everything together. It has vitamin C. It has moisturizer. It has sunscreen.

Niacinamide. Hyaluronic acid. Everything.

So you've got moisture. Brightening. Acne.

You can get creative with the bottle. Maybe the bottle has three sections. You know.

You go one. Two. Three.

Or something. Or like a. Triphasic. That you mix.

And like. Ya. So say form factor can change.

Of the bottle. Ya. But again.

These are all. Areas which are category creating. And hence community matters.

Ya. Right. So I think the trend.

The next wave you were asking. Skin minimalism. Definitely.

Skinification of makeup. I think nostalgia is not really a trend. But I think it will always come back in life.

Like whether it's fashion. Whether it's beauty. Like I think we as human beings.

Go after things we know. There's a. There's a familiarity. There's something that's familiar.

But then something that's new. Is the best way we digest it. Like if you look at music.

The remixes of like really old songs. With something new. Are the ones we immediately are like.

That's. I like this. Gen Z is getting into guzzles now.

It feels familiar. Exactly. It's insane.

They're like. So many Instagram singers. Who are now getting into.

Exactly. Mehdi Hasan. And I'm like wow.

That's incredible. And I think if you can package. Nostalgia and identity.

And India pride-ness again. I'm going to say that. But for a new India.

And for the world. I think that is the next big wave. For sure.

That's a very valid point. And minimalism. Ya that I already said.

Nostalgia. Minimalism. Okay I'm now taking note.

The nostalgia. Minimalism. It's like my next brand.

I also think there's a huge. Pick up of micro trends. So that change.

Every three to six months. So brands that kind of. Catch on to that.

Or figure a way. Of how to catch on to that trend. Then you.

Then you show the product. In a different light. For example.

Glass skin right. So that came out of Korea. Ya but it's not.

It's just that. That's all the Korean brands. Even if they were not talking about it.

Or brands that are. Inspired by Korean ingredients. Started using that trend.

As a viral moment. To resell their product. The same product that has.

As she said. Repackaged and sold. You're talking about.

The mob wife look. If I go to Korea. Ya.

I find a person. Willing to white label. Ya.

I bring back. A whole bunch of products. Because this is a country.

With better skin. And not a celebrity. So they're probably being.

A bit more honest. Will it work in India? Yes it will. I mean brands are doing it.

Ya brands are doing it. I don't know. Clayco.

D.U. Right. I think they're all. Kind of Korean inspired.

They're all Indian rappers. And Korean brands. D.U. is.

So what they do. Like the best way to. I don't know.

I think there's a. There's two differentiation right. So you're using. You're getting Korean.

You're getting brands made. Manufactured in Korea. Without any of the.

Korean inspiration. Or you're using. Korean origin.

Ingredients. And then packaging it. As a Korean brand.

Getting glass skin. And then bring it to India. Taking a Korean product.

Ya. Putting a different wrapper on it. And selling it in India.

It's 90% water. Why will you transport it all the way? It'll work. It'll work.

It's about product right. I mean my lip balm. The main ingredient is ghee.

But I'm making it in Korea. Why? Because they are. The texture.

And the sensorialism. In their ingredients. No but I think he's saying.

I just get a Korean product. So Korean brand. And then sell it to you.

But what I think is. It will work. Ya it will work.

I think they're manufacturing. At this point. I think India is coming up there.

Like our manufacturing. Getting better. But at this point.

Korea. Has certain textures. And ingredients.

And the way they mix it together. They're far ahead of the game. So I think that.

We can't mix Korean beauty here. In India. I think you can.

You can man. I think we're talking. From a quality perspective.

From a technology perspective. From innovation perspective. Hygiene.

Like. Innovation is huge. I feel like what they're saying is.

Can you make a Ferrari in India? Yes. But it won't be Ferrari right. But Ferrari and beauty.

Is very different. Because it sounds complicated. Like beauty is not.

Beauty is not just like. Mixing things in a pot. And doing it.

Like there's so many emulsifiers. So many steps. Like you gotta cool it.

You gotta heat it. And then I think. The way Korean chemists.

Specifically the manufacturing. I think you can still do in India. Because you can.

Reverse engineer the formula. But I think the chemists in Korea. Like the ingredients they use.

Like PDRN. Like they. It's salmon sperm.

Salmon sperm. Is the trendiest ingredient. In skincare today.

That came from Korea. And they literally. Create ingredients like that.

And because. They have this branding. Of having better skincare.

People as consumers. Accept it. Is it always better? I know someone who got it.

Injected into his knees. Because the logic was. Salmon sperm will help.

Who injected that? My brother. So we were traveling. Somewhere recently.

He got it into his knees. He got an IV. Into his body.

Did it help? It put him on a wheelchair. For like 4-5 days. Oh dear.

It's a caution for. Salmon sperm then. But there's also.

A lot of information. Out there. So I think.

You know. It's also about. Understanding.

That's why going back. To experts. So while it's all about.

Influencing. It's also about. Understanding.

What your skin type is. And I think that's. That's something that.

I would tell anyone. Who's starting a brand. That understand.

Who your audience is. And who you're creating for. So if it's a. Concern based salt.

Particularly for skincare. Make sure that. You also have experts.

Who back your brand. Or have them as advisors. To kind of tell you.

This is the right thing to do. But I think country. You know like.

If you look at different countries. Like we. Like what you started off earlier.

Saying that when you look at. Italy or Germany. You know they would have good color.

Good makeup. You look at France. Of course French pharmacy.

You already subconsciously. Are like French skincare. It must be good.

Like all the La Roche Posay. And the Caudalie's. Like they must be good.

Korea is this new one. That's come on. Where subconsciously.

Because they have good skin. We all are like. They must be good.

India I think has that. Globally for hair. Yeah.

Anyone thinks of Indians. They're like. They have some secret to hair.

Great point. That's. That the world needs to know.

Like what's going on there. Like I think it's. So unique to India.

It's the entire lifestyle. That we're kind of you know. Putting out there.

And anything from India. About Ayurveda. Really moves the needle.

So you're saying. A product that says. Indian hair oil.

Could do well in the West. Oh yeah. Chumpy.

It does yeah. And it will. And I think.

I think. What else are Indians known for? What else are Indians known for? Weddings. Spirituality.

Wellness. I think. Just their.

Their warmth. And love for food. I think that's another one.

Food's a biggie yeah. Food is huge. Bollywood.

Just colour. We have to build on those. Things when you build a brand.

If you want to build a global brand. Because it's subconscious. Like I think what.

What then it's like. The winds are behind you. That's helping you.

Like with Koreans. Any Korean brand. Can launch something now.

We're all like. Korean skin care. Like let's put it all over us.

So like go wear something. Because consumers already. Are thinking of you with that.

So then you don't have to like. Train them to change their mindset. You're like okay.

You think Indians do good hair care. Here. And exhibit A. My mom.

Who has hair down to her ankles. And she's 63 years old. Does she? She does.

Yeah. She has really long hair. And so it's like.

You give that exhibit. And like the same way. Shea Butter came from Africa.

Shea Marie is a brand in the US. That sells like insane. It's one of the best hair care brands there.

And the story is. The grandmother on the side of the road. Sold Shea Butter.

And look at her hair. And how amazing it made. And that story.

They've kind of built over the last. Two or three decades. And it's this amazing.

And now Shea Butter is really you know. The ingredient for moisture. And you've seen this happen in India.

Indians are known for hair. Also what else? Weddings. Weddings we said.

Food. I think just. Animals.

Animals. Animals. I think family tigers.

Like whenever. I speak to a foreigner about India. They have a mental image of like tigers.

And snakes. And all of that. Elephants.

I think family. Like there's a lot of like. Asian culture.

Asian culture right. Warmth. Vibrancy.

Like just. And yeah. I think that's.

Music. Music. Classical music.

Punjabi music also. Punjabi music. Kind of stereotyping.

But I feel like. India is very vibrant. In terms of its color palette right.

So you always expect an Indian brand. I think of like Jaipur. Like Udaipur.

Yeah yeah. That's true. Palaces.

Palatial. That stuff yeah. We've actually seen what she's saying right.

Religion. New age brands. Spirituality.

More than religion. I'd say spirituality. Really? Yeah.

Hinduism yeah. Two different things. We're saying two different things.

I don't think they look at India purely as Hinduism. Because they don't know enough about Ganesh. And like all of that.

But they look at Indians being very spiritual people. Like you know. We do our morning meditations.

None of us do. But they think we do. My husband wakes up at 5.45. He does it? Every morning to meditate.

More pious. Yeah we're a pious family. Yeah.

Not fun but. What else? Because you live there. You're a better person to answer this question as well.

This is a funny one I always say in my friend group now. But of late CEOs. Like every multinational is an Indian CEO.

Yeah intellect. Intellect. Intelligence.

Education. Like everyone in the west has that one Indian friend who's highly educated. Who's just doing really well in their career.

IT I think. So if I'm building a community. I should pick something from.

Weddings. Culture. Colourful.

Palaces. Religion. Spirituality.

Yoga. CEO. Smart.

And build on top of that. It's a good start. And food.

I think food is a big one. Food bonds us all. Because food and.

I think even native florals right. There's. Food.

Masala. Like that. No I think.

It's cultural consumption. She can take a masala. Like that could be a perfume.

Chicken tikka masala. Jalebi. Like jalebi.

She's launched jalebi. And chai. Lip balms.

So again. I wouldn't launch chicken tikka masala. I'm not sure.

I think that's one of the stuff that. Doesn't sit right. Okay.

Yeah I think what she said touched on florals as well. I think. Maybe the west doesn't know it enough.

But that is something we can scream about. Like our flowers. The jasmine.

The champaka. The firangi pani. Rajni gandha.

Rajni gandha. I think it's a really good point. And they have like roots in India.

I'm not saying they're only native to India. But they have a huge amount of storytelling. And history here.

How about temples? Temple smell? What if Dilip sells temple scent? That ittar. Phool. Phool.

Phool and ittar. That whole thing is used temple flowers. What if Dilip's perfume brand is called temple? Cute.

I like it. Yeah. Agarbatti is like a very very.

Agarbatti needs to be disrupted. Yeah. But we're saying bring back the old in a new way.

Yeah. So temple maybe has a hint of agarbatti somewhere. The perfume.

But you can also make it your bodies. Your temple. It has camphor.

Exactly. So agarbatti for example. The smell.

Yeah the smell actually is about cleansing the home. That's what the Indian home does. And camphor is also about like.

You know good energy. And making sure that you're purifying your space. Dilip is starting to feel better.

That's great. Is there a tech play here to identify which product? Let's say we are doing morning. Night.

There's two products. Morning has sunscreen plus moisturizer plus niacinamide plus vitamin C. Night has. Peptide.

Magnesium and retinol. Yeah. Okay.

Good. And if we combine. If we have two bottles in the bathroom.

A. I would love that because it removes so much clutter. Is there a tech play to figure out. Deepa's morning is different from Nikhil's morning.

And Bhakti's night is different from Shantanu's. Using AI? Using anything. AI.

If you have enough data for sure. No just about taking a picture of your face. And asking a genetic AI to tell you.

Which product. Which either pick morning one or morning two. I mean there's a lot of advances in that.

My only concern with that then is. Are you going to the model of hyper personalization. Because then operationally.

I don't know how that's going to work. That's what we were saying. It's just too many permutations combinations.

What if you only have three skills. Three mornings and three nights. Okay then it can work.

Then you come on the website. You come on the website. You show.

Take a photo. Do a quiz. Give your details.

No quiz. Nothing. No questions.

Just photo. That's fine as well. We can tell you.

There's skin analyzers that'll tell you. Only thing with that is. You're not giving it your environment.

Are you hot? Humid? Cold? Are you living in Canada? But you can add that layer as well. I can

figure out your location. No you can take a. Yeah you can put in your location.

So just one picture. Yeah. That's doable.

You walk into a website. One picture. That you take there.

And then you say. Morning two is right for you. And night three is right for you.

Send it done. And age. The picture has to calculate.

Because the physical age. Does not matter with skin. And you can do a try before you buy.

Saying okay. Try it. If you like it.

I mean and you. You know you pre-book it. If you don't like it.

You can send it back to me. And I'll give you your money back. So you can absolutely do that.

I'm just saying it for a brand. Because a brand. Il Makiage has done this.

They have the try before you buy. And they've also built. Their tech platform called Audity.

Which is all about again. Really predicting. What shade will match you.

So they sometimes. Will send you three shades. In color.

I see this work very well. Because now you have. Lipstick try-ons.

You have. Virtual try-ons. Everything in color.

But even with skin care. Because if you have tech. That's good enough to kind of.

Give you at least. 96 to 98 percent accuracy. If it can indeed like.

Zoom in and analyze. Oh he has pores. Or he has under eye circles.

Or he has acne. Then he needs these. And these ingredients.

Or he looks a bit older. So he needs more like. Peptides and that stuff.

Yeah. And we can change the. Form factor of the bottle.

To have one to three. Yeah. So you put one on.

Then two on. Then three on. You love your one, two, three.

No but if you're going to have. Fewer SKUs. I hate looking at clutter.

And each time I go into my bathroom. If you have fewer SKUs. Then you don't need tech.

I think it's. The juice is not worth. The SKUs at all.

No he's saying tech. So that the customer knows. What they should get.

He basically doesn't want to. Interact with anyone. He's like.

This is it. No but what the customer. Will figure it out.

The tech is when. What she's saying is right. Customer figuring out.

Is very hard. How will the customer figure it out? I don't know what I should use. The brand has three SKUs.

They'll figure out. On YouTube. But I think for sure.

How would a customer know. You believe the customer. Knows everything.

You have to. If they don't have. Any information.

Can I tell you. I have no clue. What is good for my skin.

You knew peptides though. Yeah. But I have no clue.

What I should use. When I should use. If something is right for me.

If you want to solve that problem. Then you can't have. A three SKU business.

Sorry. You can't have a three SKU business. The morning one.

Because you're super blending everything. I mean he's. When I was believing.

That this is the right one. Your premise is that. I'm going to mix everything.

And give it to you. Then you're like. I'm mixing everything.

And giving it to you. Now you'll tell me. Everything man.

So you choose one. I think what he's saying. Is not everything.

Not every active ingredient. But he's saying. One becomes a supersonic.

Brightening one. One becomes a supersonic. Anti-aging one.

One becomes a supersonic. Acne one. Correct.

You know. And then. People whose skin.

Is more prone to one or the other. They'll know. They get that.

How will they know. Acne. I don't know.

I need acne. I don't. Aging.

I think. You don't have acne. You don't need it.

No but. Guys also. We're super simplifying it.

I think also. I don't think you can. One element.

That we're also missing. Is while. All of this is great.

Consumers. Today. Still buy.

80% of beauty. For the first time. In a store.

In an offline environment. Because. The emotional.

Touch. Feel. Factor.

Is still so huge. In beauty right. That you want to.

80%. That's a shocking. 2028.

Beauty will be. 33%. Online.

And. 67%. But the trend.

Is going more online. It is. But it.

I feel like. Offline will still. Dominate.

Significantly. There will still be. Always a healthy mix.

I think for. That's why we say. First purchase.

And then. Second purchase. Is definitely online.

But that's why. Offline is moving. To being all about.

Experiences. It's all about. Experiential marketing.

It's all about. Creating your stores. As experience centers.

You know. For people. Who travel a lot.

Like I travel. Incessantly. I've been traveling.

For the last three months. I'm not going to carry. 10 bottles with me.

But minis. You can carry. But we agree.

Minis. Skin minimalism. Is the thing.

I think also for supplements. Yeah. I'm not going to carry.

10 boxes of. Like what AG1. Do you know AG1.

What AG1 did with. Supplementation was. Phenomenal.

Like I was waiting. For that my whole life. And now.

Parallel is another supplement. Brand in the US. UV backed as well.

And they put all your supplements. In one packet. So it's like.

You just have to open the packet. And just take it in the morning. Why not even in one pill.

I think because. Active ingredients can. Interact with each other.

Like an omega 3. Is an oil based. But like maybe vitamin C. Is a powder based so. Yeah but I think.

Simplifying. Time. And.

Simplifying life by. Optimizing for time. Is a great idea.

Bathroom break. I think they wanted. No.

I can take one. Yeah I don't mind. Yeah I don't mind.

Take a bathroom break. You guys hungry? I like your tattoos. What do they say? So my job.

Is that of a trader. In the stock market. It's primary job.

So delay gratification. Is a reminder. Not to sell stuff fast.

Which I tend to do a lot. Without the tattoo. You would forget.

Be patient. I don't remember with the tattoo. So.

Be here now. Is not. I have a tendency.

To procrastinate. I spent a lot of my life. Thinking what will happen.

Five years from now. Ten years from now. That.

This says. Do. Unto others.

As you would have. Others do unto you. Which I feel like.

Is a. Simple model. If you had to pick one to live by. Yeah.

And this is my handwriting. I like that. And all together.

In different moments in life. Different moments in life. That's really nice.

Very cool. And the date. Of when I got it.

Is also there. See this 2013. Very cool.

Do you have tattoos? Yeah a bunch. This one is the funniest. Back then tattoos used to be quite.

The thick. Now you can make them really thin. And beautiful.

But like these are bleeding. A little into each other. But it's Roman.

And it's like a conversation starter. Every time someone's like. Oh what does your tattoo say? I'm like decode it.

But it basically is. Roman numerals. For the letter G. Is the 11th letter in the alphabet.

R I T. So when I was in my final year. In high school. I did a thesis.

On what makes people successful. I think it was my social psychology. Class or something.

I was obsessed with. How do people become successful? What is it that makes them different. From everybody else.

And long story short. The end answer was grit. That whether you have money or not.

Whether you're beautiful or not. Whether you have the right people. If you just have grit.

That was a common denominator. In every successful person. And so I was like.

I need to tattoo that. What is the biggest thing you have going for you? Why is Deepa successful? Why is Deepa successful? Oh can I have multiple answers? Grit. In the face of adversity? Yeah.

Adversity being? I mean as an entrepreneur. As a founder. You're hit with.

Like the velocity. And the amount of shit. That hits you on a daily basis.

And whether it's rejections. Or no's. Or things not working out.

And I think a good founder. An entrepreneur is the one. Who's able to take that.

And come on the other side. Over and over and over again. Even when you think.

Finally I'm on the other side. The sun is shining. You know the sales are great.

Something else will come around. So I think people. Who can really withstand that.

Will end up being. Good entrepreneurs. According to me.

And pre-entrepreneurship? Pre-entrepreneurship. I think I just. Really wanted to be somebody.

That did something with her life. Like I wanted to be. Like leave a mark.

I know it sounds a bit cliche. But my biggest fear. Was to die ordinary.

I'm like what if. What if I don't become. An anybody or nobody.

Like you get this one life to live. Make it count. You know.

That was something. That always kept me going. As a child.

Like make sure. You do something worthwhile. Make sure your life.

Means something. And make sure. Also means something.

Bigger than yourself. Interesting. Digressing from our subject.

For a second. You didn't tell us. About how you started Teera.

And you didn't finish. What happened after Mackenzie. Maybe we do a little bit.

Of your lives. You want to go first? Okay. So I had nothing.

To do with beauty. I started. You know.

Did my undergrad. In psychology. And communication.

Graduated. And got my first job. At Macy's.

But you know. As a management trainee. And then in fashion.

You weren't really going to get. You know. Anything post your OPT.

So my dad was like. Come home. And you know.

Figure it out. So had nothing. Had no plan.

I think I've always kind of. Been I like to say. Good at many things.

And you know. Like I was average. At a lot of things.

I was good at a lot of things. And I think. So always trying to find.

That one purpose. That kind of. You know.

What is it. That will make me feel. Oh wow.

I've got it as well. You know. Because you keep looking.

At other people. And everyone. Has something about them.

Or they know. What they want to do. And I think it can be easy.

Having a dad. Like your dad as well. But I don't think.

I feel the opposite is true. It can or it can't be easy. I think depends on the kid.

The unhappiest people I know. Are people who have these. Really really large figures.

As their parents. Because happiness is always relative. And you get your validation.

When you get something. Beyond what they have. And if you start at that scale.

Like I could have gone from A to B. And got validated. She has to go from Z to Z plus. Yeah.

But I don't think. I think that when I've. What I liked about my childhood.

Was yeah. I grew up in a. Conservative household. My parents were strict.

You know. Follow deadlines. I wasn't allowed to be out till.

1 a.m. My dad always opened the door. Even you know. Didn't have the keys to my house.

Even when I grew up. But I think that. The one thing that I'm very grateful for.

Is that I grew up without pressure. I grew up. Sweetie that's probably because.

People were trying to kidnap you. No I think that's what. That trend has kind of followed me.

I you know graduated. And then came here. And as a 21 year old.

Was very enamored. With this whole retail side right. And Reliance Brands.

It just started up. And my first ever gig. Was when you know.

Darshan told me. He's like okay. You want to work in retail.

Then you need to know how to sell. So my first job was selling shoes. On the Timberlands storefronts.

He said you will be allowed. To enter my office. After you want to.

You've actually sold something. And I was like okay cool. I'll do it.

So I've done the you know. The six to eight month. You know shop front associate.

Sales associate job. And I was selling. Selling Timberland shoes.

And in Mumbai. Where the weather is completely. You know not accustomed.

To selling winter wear. And I learned something. I learned this one rule.

From my boss at that time. Where he said that. It's a rule in the retail.

Industry that. Particularly for footwear. So someone's coming to buy.

You know buy one pair of shoes. You bring out three for them. Because if you don't.

They don't like that one. You sell them. You make them try the other two.

So it was a three box rule. And for me you know. I remember I told my sister.

My dad that oh we're having. An end of season sale. And you know my mom and him came.

And they bought that one pair of shoe. Just to you know it was that. That really also again.

Validated that. It didn't to that 21 year old. Meant a lot.

Because for me that was like. Oh wow. I've done that thing for myself.

And then I worked in retail. For about I had you know. And you're talking about.

Having this having this. Large larger than life. You know figure.

I think I used. I turned that as an opportunity. I got access to opportunity.

And I never took it to waste. I believed that I had. And I had access.

And I really really used it. I feel like I've. Overcompensated at times.

You know I would. I would sometimes. Be the last one to stay back.

And I wanted to always. Prove that I could do it. And at some point.

I just embraced it. Yes this is who I am. And I'm going to make.

Use of everything that I have. And I'm going to do it. You know I didn't know.

What I was going to do. When I was 21. But I worked through.

Multiple roles. And I still was figuring it out. I worked in fashion.

For eight eight years. I did buying. I worked at RGO.

And I. When I got married. After working in Reliance Brands. For about five years.

I moved to RGO. And I did something completely different. Which was inventory planning.

My my boss at that time. Asked me that. Yes you can do marketing.

Or do something completely different. And learn to inventory planning. So I learned all about.

Couponing. Discounting. How do you manage inventory.

How do you look at. You know how do you. Calculate everything.

When it comes to e-commerce. I learned the basics then. And I think I'm grateful.

For the opportunities. And also the people that I met. Through that time.

To kind of you know. Kind of give me that confidence. That okay you know.

You I got a varied. Just multitudes of opportunity. That I would have not got.

And I'm so grateful. Super grateful for that. And after that I was.

I was in fashion for so many years. I was like. That's when that.

Oh I want to do something on my own. Like I I believed. That I could do a lot more.

And I was like okay. I want to now get out. And do my own thing.

And I was like okay. I think I want to go to school again. I always thought that.

I wanted to go back to school. And do something. That was completely different.

From what I had done. And I wanted to then. Be in the fashion space.

I said okay I'll. I applied to Parsons. For their AAS degree.

Which is you know. For people who want to change careers. So I had friends.

Who were lawyers. Who were doctors. Who all wanted to get.

Into the fashion space. So you basically take. A four-year course.

Condense it into a two-year course. And I got married. Moved to Bangalore.

And after one year. I decided just to move. To New York for two years.

So I did long distance marriage. And studied for those two years. Purely out of passion.

To wanting to build. Something for myself. And I was like.

It really works no? Long distance marriage. It's great. I I I think that.

I give so much credit. To my husband. My partner Tejas.

Because I think that. There was no conversation. About you are allowed.

Which you know. Kind of stems. These conversation stems.

You yeah. I'm allowing you to go. You should do this.

It was always like. You want to do this. Let's figure it out.

And you have my entire support. So I think that. That kind of set the bar for me.

On what I expected right. And I think that. That I don't think.

My parents ever asked me once. That are you guys okay. Just purely out of.

When anyone saw. And it's not like. We didn't have a fair share.

Of fights and quarrels. But never for a moment. Did that did.

Did just walk out. And he all he he. He knew he's like.

You made the move. To Bangalore for me. And it's it's only fair.

That I do that for you. Because you want to do this. Because imagine.

If he had to go to MBA. It would be easy that. Oh Bhakti will go with him right.

Nothing no no. No one would say anything. If if it's the opposite.

And people still gave him. A lot of credit. Which I do as well.

But I also went right. So that kind of. Gets lost in the whole process.

But I think. We've kind of been. We're okay with.

Letting that limelight go. But I think. Then when it was COVID.

We lived in New York. For one year. After my two-year degree.

Because I was like okay. I'm not coming back. I have a couple of more.

Months at school. And he took the last flight out. And came to New York.

And we were stuck in the pandemic. For an entire year. And I think it was.

The best time that we had. In our bubble. Just figuring it out.

And I didn't. That was at one year. Where I did not work.

Since I started working. And I was like okay. What do I want to do? I wanted to at that point.

Start my own athleisure brand. So I was making all my plans. Speaking to my dad.

Saying okay great. So putting all my plans together. And plans never go.

The way they're meant to. I moved back to India. And I started again.

Working a little bit. On the design side. With with trends.

The entire fashion. And lifestyle business. Is in Bangalore.

So I was trying to. See how I could actually. Put my skills to test.

So I was working on. Designing a small collection. And then beauty.

Just happened to be a conversation. That I was part of. As a consumer.

And then nothing was planned. I remember having this conversation. With Isha where I told her.

I said I'm just going to. I'll be around. And I definitely want to do my own thing.

She said yeah of course. You go ahead. And it'll all work out.

And that was the plan. And then. There was no set moment.

It was we. We named Teera together. We had about two days.

To name Teera together. I know that. Me and her have this Google sheet.

Where we came up with names. Like Sorbet. Blush.

And then. That's it. I'll get to that.

And then. And it was just such a. Easy flow in that. You know we started from there.

So we named it Teera. Because we were thinking. Of what are some of the best.

You know the genesis of. Some of the most powerful brand names. And if you think there's Nike.

Which is from Greek mythology. Because Nike is a goddess of power. Sephora is from the goddess Zephyrus.

So everything was rooted. These brands were rooted in power. In Greek mythology.

So we're like. We're in India. We have so much history.

So much culture. Let's go back to Hindu mythology. And then we looked up.

Some of the Indian goddesses. And goddess Rati. Who's the goddess of love.

Passion. And beauty. And we're like.

Can we make. You know. Teera is an anagram.

Of goddess Rati. And the entire idea. Is that when any person.

Looks at themselves in the mirror. They see. You know.

Every person has a unique superpower. Because goddesses have superpowers. And that unique superpower.

On the inside. Helps you feel beautiful. In the outside.

And Teera celebrates that superpower. So. I think.

And we didn't use an agency. And you light up. When you speak about Teera.

It's so nice. Yeah. Why don't you keep it Rati.

And not. Why don't you like change it around. I think it's also about.

It's more modern. Yeah. We wanted to also let.

We were making it. For the Indian consumer. But also for the.

We wanted to be a global retailer. For the Indian consumer. I think we were both.

I think the beauty of it is that. We always looked at the brand. As consumers of beauty.

And what we wanted. The Indian. What we wanted to.

Have that shopping experience in India. Right. So every decision we made.

Was from that perspective. Versus saying. Okay.

Let's look at. What else is happening out in India. I think.

And that. That gave such a fresh perspective. To what.

We were trying to do with Teera. And yeah. What's cool about Bhakti also.

Whenever we run into. Each other in a function. I gravitate towards.

Her and her husband. And I hang out with them. I couldn't quite put my finger on why.

But. If I asked. The question I asked her.

To people. In her shoes. Nine out of ten.

Would be masking. Insecurity with some form of ego. Saying.

I did this. It takes a certain amount of. Evolution to.

Not do that. Compliment her father. Then her husband.

And place credit elsewhere. And not take any. Thank you.

She's nice. I don't know how to take that. But thank you.

The Rati. Teera story. I think more people should hear about it.

It's really beautiful. Thank you. Yeah.

And I think. That happened without an agency. And our.

Our tagline is. Teera for every you. So we're not.

You know. When we spoke about beauty. Is self-expression.

I think for us. It's celebrating. Every journey.

Every part of your beauty journey. And also just. Kind of.

You know. Alluding to the fact that. Wherever you are in your life.

Even if it's a bad time. We got you. And we want to celebrate.

That version of you. We don't want you to evolve. We want you to be in that moment.

Because we are with you. And I think. That kind of came from.

As women. What we feel on a daily basis. Right.

That we want someone to just tell us. You are enough. And I think that.

That really. That that is very personal to me. And.

I would like to also. You know. From.

If you're talking about like. Watched by Tira. So.

So special to both. Both Isha. And I think.

From a perspective of. Just championing. What women leaders can be.

Right. And beauty is a space. Where we've been able to do that.

We have 60% women leaders. And we have. One of the highest diversity ratios.

And you know. We've. I have 100% success rate in women.

Having every. Anyone who comes to Tira. Has a baby.

Goes into their maternity leave. And comes back. And I think we've.

We've. I'm so happy. I didn't know that.

I was so passionate about it. But when I started this. I saw what a difference we made.

To women leaders. And when people are coming back. From maternity.

Taking a break. And coming back. And seeing those leaders.

And the kind of hunger they have. Has just been. You know.

And. An unknowing. Success that you know.

That I feel more proud of. Than anything else you know. That we've been able to do that.

And to. I understood the power of like. You know.

When so many women come together. What they can put together. So I think that has been.

The most special part about Tira. That it has this amazing energy. That there's everyone.

Who kind of wants to do something. Like they want. They also want to find themselves.

And prove themselves. And I think. That has resonated a lot with me.

If I build my brand. Dilip the fragrance. Or me with.

Morning and night. Skincare product. How do I pitch? Was I going to be Nikhil Kamat's line? Morning and night.

Yeah. How do I pitch it to you? Um. To Tira.

Particularly. I think. I think that the one thing.

That we are Tira. You know. In terms of our mission.

And vision. We've said that we want to be. Aspirational.

Affordable. Yet aspirational. And whether we're selling.

200 rupee lipstick. Or a 2000 rupee lipstick. We want the consumer.

Consumer experience. To be premium. Right.

So whether it's. Whether it's the UI UX. That's clutter free.

Or whether it's. Not really throwing. The constant discounting.

In your face. Or leading with education. Having an editorial approach.

I think that has really been. You know. A differentiator for us.

And I think. When it comes to a brand. Particularly homegrown brands.

Right. We want to champion them. And for us.

It would mean that. Have a good brand story. Have a solid product.

And you know. We again really enjoy. Working with founders as well.

So I think for us. It would be. For me particularly.

Would be to have great product. Right. And fit into that ecosystem.

So we're not. We're not being picky about. About a brand.

I feel like if you're. Entering into the brand. Even if you're a young brand.

We would definitely. Want to work with you. How do I reach out to you? You email us.

I'm. So the number of people. Who reach out to me on LinkedIn.

Is also insane. And even if I can't reply. I will connect you to.

Connect you to the merchandising team. And you know. They at least have the convos.

There will be times when. You know. You've not reached a certain scale.

And you know. You're just starting to distribute. And sometimes that.

You can also get lost in the. Entire. The number of brands that we have.

So I think. When you've got a little. When you just started.

I think it's. Gained a little bit of traction. Like we've worked with.

Very small brands. Like we spoke about Clayco. You know.

I think it's about discovery. You want to have more brands. To lead discovery.

And I feel like as a. As a platform with scale. It is our. It is a little bit of our duty.

To kind of also set that platform. Right. So I think.

For us it's important. So as long as. You're a brand with solid product.

Is there a product. You're looking for right now. The odds would be higher.

If I build that. No. I don't think so.

I think see. We're a retailer. We want to be able to.

So give the variety. To the audience. Yeah that's your job.

I think what our job. Is to make sure that your brand. Is going to the right consumer.

So we spoke about. Hyper personalization. So if I can.

If I understand. Who my consumer is. And if that consumer.

Is your consumer. Then I'm doing right by you. And then it makes sense.

For you to list with me. And then I would want you. Right so I think for us.

It is about having. A large portfolio of brands. But also then making sure.

That the right brand. Is going to the right. We're connecting.

To the right consumer. And that is all about. The personalization.

If I bring. If I build. My morning and night.

Yeah. One form factor. Which does it all.

Correct. And I build a tech layer. On top of it.

Which is housed in Tira. For example. And it does really well.

At some point. Won't Bhakti think. Why don't I just do this myself.

Yes. Absolutely. But that's a disincentive.

For me to then. Sell on Tira right. No I don't think so.

I think. First and foremost. We're a retailer right.

So I think that. We will always make sure. That we will always.

Support the brand. And if we're getting. Into something.

It's great for the consumer. Because you're giving. The consumer choice.

And they can decide. What they want to. I think it's.

It's pure retail. So I don't think it's about. It's also there's.

There's so many different ways. Now of working with brands. As collaborations.

There's exclusivity. So if you tell me. That I'm going to be.

Exclusive to you. And you know. We get into.

I get. I make money off your brand. Then I'm like great.

Because it also takes. That much amount of time. And effort to create.

Another brand right. So I would also. Want to create a brand.

In a wide space. That I know is going. To win quickly.

And you guys. Have done that right. With a few of the celebrities.

And yes. Also the recent. Ayurvedic one.

You just launched a brand. Called Pura Veda. Are celebrity brands working? I think that.

I think they are working. Yes. I think.

But I feel like. Not the way. They were working in the past.

I think that you need. To have solid product. You need to still have.

You need to have that hook. That links you. To the consumer today.

And it's not just. About slapping your. Slapping your photo.

On a product. That those days are gone. You need to be able.

To connect with the consumer. The consumer. Buys the product.

For you. And also for the quality. So it.

You need to have. Story. A very strong storyline.

That. Depicts what you. Kind of stand for.

And they take a little bit. Of your thought. A piece of you.

Or something that you stand for. So it is very important. For a celebrity.

To be authentic. I think. Exactly the entitlement.

That sometimes. Really famous people have. Of like if I just.

Promote something. It should be fine. I think that has.

Really really really shifted. Because we've all mentioned. Consumers are very smart today.

They want value. They want quality. They want.

Good ingredients. And just. Slapping a celebrity face.

Doesn't cut it anymore. So I mean. Which brand are you thinking of? I'm not going to mention the name.

I'm not going to mention the name. But there is so many. Celebrity brands in India.

I think I know what you're thinking. And globally. And globally of course.

That have started. And then. If you're just not.

Into it enough. Like for example. If you come on.

And somebody. You're doing a live. Or you're doing a video.

And somebody's like. What ingredients does your product have? And you're like. Oh my moisturizer moisturizes.

Like we're not dumb. Like we can see. You don't know enough about it.

And then you ask another founder. Who really is deeply involved. Whether that's a rare beauty.

Whether that's. Fenty. You could literally wake them up.

In the middle of the night. And be like. What is the name of your blush.

And shade blah blah blah. What ingredient does it have? I think they're so deeply. For me 100%.

Like I would know for sure. Anything you ask me. Even the name of our warehouse.

In the US or UK or whatever. I would know those things. Because we're so deeply involved.

And I think they see that. They see that involvement. They see that love.

And they see that care. And I think that translates to sales. And if a celebrity can do that.

It still works. If they cannot. Because they're really busy being.

Actresses or influencers. Or whatever else. Then I don't think it works.

What are some of the examples. Of celebrity brands. That have worked.

And what did they get right? Not necessarily in beauty. Anything. India.

Latest one. I really liked Underneath. What is Underneath? Underneath is Kusha Kapila's lingerie brand.

Super You by Ranveer. Very good start. Very good start.

What celebrity should start what brand? What celebrity should start what? Give me a name. Shah Rukh Khan. Fragrance.

100%. Fragrance. 100%.

We all said it. We'll all invest in it. So me Dilip should.

Try and pitch him to be the partner. Give him 30%. Like that's half your job done.

And get Prashant to invest. Put 2 crores guys to 25. And you're home.

So Prashant. The friend you met. Yeah.

He founded a. Venture capital company called Axial. Oh. So they've been the first check in.

Flipkart. Flipkart, Swiggy, Ola. All the tech companies.

I think we spoke to them. Hmm. Very good.

Very savvy investors. I think even they're looking at some beauty brands. He would have had some insight.

My Glam. My Glam. My Glam.

That's not doing too well. My Glam is. I think the Kardashians are amazing examples.

Of what it means to create a brand. They sell everything. What I find they're also really good at.

Is even if something fails. They just push it under the rug. And start the next one.

Yeah and. Like they don't care about failure. They're just like.

Okay that didn't work fine. Let's start the next one. Skims I think.

Skims has. She lives, breathes. And really really buys into.

Skims. Skims. Has again taken.

Not just beauty. Taken a category. And again.

I think we need to mention the operator. I'm agreed. And like the product.

Like the product of Skims. Is phenomenal. Is it? So people come back for it.

I think. Celebrity influencers were great. Like trampoline.

Like I said. But the product will bring you back. I agree.

You know. The marketing. The branding.

You need. Product is still king right. If you don't have product.

You can build a brand. But you're not really going to. You won't have any repeat.

Yeah exactly. It's going to. But I think in beauty.

Both Rare and Fenty are. I think gold standards. For being able to road.

But I still think. When it comes to a storytelling. I think that Rare.

With the mental health impact. And Rihanna with the. With inclusivity.

And diversity. And really championing those. Two causes has made it.

You know. It's gone beyond the founders. So now that cause.

And the brand has gotten related. It's the singular thing. That creates a community.

And they have built communities. And that's what I think. Has driven it.

They have made themselves. Relevant as people. Moved away from the celebrity status.

And kind of champion something. That is core to all of us. And I think.

That is what they've sold. And I think. That's what a lot of.

Let's say Indian celebrities. Have seen. Where they're like.

Oh. After their relevance. As a pop star.

Or as an actress. Died out. They're still saying.

Relevant with the business. Let's do it too. And I think.

That's the wrong intention. To start a business. Just for the.

Oh I'll be in the buzz. And I'll make a quick buck. But I think.

If you truly start. For like we said. With the cause.

The why. What was my first question to you? What's your why? Like if that's really strong. Then the business.

Will become bigger than you. Like it will sustain. I think HRX did a very good job.

Because I think. Hrithik was involved. I think the product was good.

And I think the distribution. With Myntra was outstanding. They did such a good job.

With that brand. HRX is a good celebrity brand. Big.

So I have to figure out. The product first. And then find the celebrity.

And then the distribution. Coming to you with a brand. Let me know.

It's going to be Nikhil 123. Dilip 123. What was your why? You just spoke about why.

My why was truly. To create. India's first global beauty brand.

And to be on the shelves. Of Sephora. That I never saw growing up.

Like you know. It was all French brands. It was all American brands.

And I didn't feel seen in that. And I think creating a brand. With so much pride.

From where we come from. And being able to stand. On those global shelves.

Is uncharted territory. And honestly. Freaks the shit out of me to do it.

It really does. To really take on the US market. Which is a beast.

Of a beauty market. With sitting next to brands. Like all these ones.

That we mentioned. But that is the why. It's like.

We need to build something. From our country. That can do that.

And truly be global. And have that. Like have us Indians.

Be proud of our skin. Our skin type. Our ingredients.

And everything that we come from. If I were to ask you. Why enough number of times.

And you don't have a filter on. You'll go back to first principles. Identity.

Like my own identity. Perhaps. Yeah.

But in that mirror. The identity of the community. That I built I think.

Ultimately yes. I'm really proud of it too. And I think there's definitely.

An identity piece there. But I think it just makes. Like it's a national pride.

In a way as well. And I think the community. Of the women that I've built.

So far together. I think we've all had this. Very clear friction points.

Where I think maybe. I told Bhakti when I was first. Pitching it well to her as well.

It's like you know. There's this. On the one hand.

We love where we come from. We love being Indian. We love our food.

The culture. All the lists that we made. We love it.

But at the same time. We're not our moms and grandmothers. We're modern Indian women.

Who want to talk about sex. If we do. We want to like.

Stay with somebody. Before we marry them. We believe in science.

And fact. And there's almost this. Dichotomy.

And a friction between us. And there was no brand. That brought them together.

That so. In their world. Is an identity.

Of that friction point. In a bottle. It is Ayurveda.

And everything mom. And grandmom said. Use ghee.

Use turmeric. But it's cutting edge. Clinical vitamin C. Niacinamide.

Put together in a bottle. So that's me. Deepa.

I see that. And that is my. That's me.

So I can identify with it. In their world. Yeah.

Thank you. I suspect you will do. You're already doing well.

But after this. I think you'll do exponentially well. That's very kind.

You come across as a. Great spokesperson. For an Indian mom. Thank you.

Thank you. And you own so many things. Which is also nice.

White man. Okay. Once you meet him.

You will love him. He's more Indian. Thank you.

I was just going to say that. He's literally. He's Indian inside.

Like he. His entire life. Even though he's as.

White, blonde, blue eyed as they get. Like literally Scandi vibes. He has always been eastward looking.

I think he was in his past janam. In his last life. I think he was Indian.

Like he literally. Just. I'll get you to meet him.

You'll see what I mean. You'll love him. I should have met him.

Day before yesterday, right? Yeah. I missed it. When we spoke about categories first.

We said. What is mass? What is premium? And what is prestige? Is there a case to be made. For premiumization happening fast? Which category is growing faster? Is there a case of premium? 100%.

Are you saying the 2300 prestige. Category is growing fastest? It is growing. Yes.

Yeah. Premium to prestige is growing. Premium to prestige is growing.

The fastest. Mass is plateauing. And even mass brands.

Are looking to premiumize. So I think it's about. Premiumization at every level.

While prestige is growing. Because it's such a small market. At every level.

We are premiumizing. Mainly because multiple. Like India has a lot Indian.

The target audience. Has a lot more disposable income. And the expansion into tier two.

Tier three cities. And just break out of online. Right? So there is reachability.

And awareness and access. So people want better. They want quality.

So at every level. You premiumize. So people want that aspiration.

To move up. It's not just there. It's at every level.

So I think it's premiumization. Across the board. Versus just in that segment.

If I have to put it. Yeah agreed. I think wealth equals.

I want better quality. I want better things. I want.

Are you seeing that in society? That discretionary spending. Power is going up at such a pace. Why are you building in mass then? So the two are very different questions.

I think the first question. Is around discretionary. Spending power going up.

I think it's concentrated. In the top one to five percent. Beyond the next five.

From five to hundred percent. It's going up. Because people are not.

Buying homes enough. So you now have a lot more. Money in your hand.

Because you don't have a loan. To pay off. That's global also.

India also. That's why people are able. To spend more.

Because they're saving less. Our savings rate has come down. By like thousand bips.

But the gen Z is all about experiences. Also. Now you're experiencing.

Like there's experience. And hence you know. Coffee shops.

We rent and. Yeah. This concept of small luxuries.

I don't know. Like the Labubu. Is just an example of that right.

That you're getting. A piece of a small luxury. Like you may not be able.

To buy a handbag of that brand. But you can buy. A small beauty product.

And beauty is the biggest. One of that. Yeah.

So it's about. Getting a little piece. Of that next thing.

You may not be able. To take a big holiday. But you can get.

That that fragrance. That reminds you of it. So I think.

That that small little luxuries. Is another trend. That's going.

That's kind of feeding. Into this. And I think women.

Entering the workforce. Like a generation before. Women did not enter.

It was looked down upon. In a family for women would work. And I think women.

Entering the workforce. Young women. Entering the workforce.

Having that disposable income. But still live. With their parents.

So their entire salary. Is let's go shopping. So I think.

A lot of these changes. In society. Are especially.

For the beauty industry. Really really strong. Kind of trends.

To help grow that. And then they have. Social media.

Let's not forget. Where they look. At global brands.

They look at global trends. And they're like. I want that nice cinema.

Da da da as well. Or I want that face mask. Da da da as well.

We have 500 million. Social media users. In India.

Just give or take. If I were to like. Project a. Average Indian girl.

Who is 25 years old. And is making. Say 10,000 dollars.

A year in income. How has. The beauty category.

Of my spend. Discretionary spend. Changed in the last five years.

In the last five years. Has it like doubled? Do I spend today. 20 percent of my income.

And five years ago. It was 10. Or 30 percent.

I don't know. I think it's. I think it's a lot.

More about awareness. So you know. An average.

Average Indian. Probably spends about. 10 dollars on beauty.

Versus now. With platforms. And brands coming in.

That has gone anywhere. Up to you know. 80 dollars.

In our offline stores right. And even though. We're looking at.

Premium to prestige. Online it's still. If you say.

You know consumers. Purchasing twice a year. Still about.

3,600 to 4,000 rupees. In the year. That they're spending.

Even if it's just. You know someone who's. Freshly out of college.

They will wait. To buy that one. Dior lipstick.

Or they will build. Their entire skincare routine. And that 4,000 rupees.

But the good thing is. There is availability. To do that now.

Earlier there wasn't. So it's. It's also about.

Moving that wallet share. There right. So I think that has happened.

And as I said. At every level. There's been premiumization.

So. It's not so much. About doubling it.

But it's about. Getting spending. A little bit more.

Yeah. Because of availability. As well like.

From my perspective. I only know. In their wallet data.

But like if you look at. Our AOV year on year. It's been increasing.

Year on year. In the last three years. Our AOV in India.

Has just gone bigger. And bigger the basket size. So people are able.

To spend more. And even back to. Sorry to sound like.

A broken record. But the Chumpy example. Nobody would have given me.

5 cents for the idea. Let's launch a hair oil. In the country of hair oils.

Price it 950 rupees. For 50 ml. And that.

You're going to do well. Imagine. In five years ago.

When in the country of. Every hair oil. You can possibly imagine.

You're going to price it at 950. And sell it at 50 ml. And they were like.

It's not going to work. Like who are you. To sell a hair oil.

And just people. Accepted. They want that.

They want it. Because they know. It works.

They. Believe in the quality. They like the packaging.

They like the story. They just. They have the money.

Can I ask a question. So what he's saying. Okay.

So the biggest pie. Is still mass. But the fastest growing.

Is the category. That's the baseline. Is very low.

Yeah. But also you guys. Have a lot more competition.

As well. And mass. There's so many.

It's a crowded market. As well. Depends.

So soap. Yes. Shaving not at all.

Shaving okay. So I'll give you an example. In my world.

There are 30 crore shavers. In the country. 30 crore.

300 million. People who shave. 15 crore of them.

Use 1 rupee blades. 15 crore. Half the market.

Use 1 rupee blades. 7 to 8 crore people. Go to barber shops.

5 crore people. Use disposable blades. 1 crore people.

Use premium blades. Out of 30 crore. 3 percent.

All of us will assume. Mark 3 is like the biggest. It's a crown jewel brand globally.

And Gillette is the best. I respect that company like crazy. Their inability to take someone.

Buying a 1 rupee blade. Or a 20 rupee disposable. To a 200 rupee Mark 3 is.

They just can't do it. We are not premiumized. Look at Colgate.

It's a 6,000 crore company. 50 percent market share. The most successful.

Penetration brand possible. 70 percent of the business. Comes from 10 to 12 rupee toothpaste.

And they have outstanding. Premium products. So you'll have a Perfora here.

Sensodyne is a good example. But the thing Shantanu. Is also that.

It's not just. It's not that. As we said.

That sector is small. But it's premiumization. At every level.

So that 10 to 12 rupees. Will be 15 to 16 rupees. I'm saying that is the trend.

Will that happen in general? It's very difficult. Because of inflation. And the price.

Net of inflation. So net of inflation. Okay.

Large markets. Every CEO. You hear Priya.

Or Prabha. Or you know. Gaurav at Rekha.

Everyone says. We need to premiumize. Whether it's a Dettol.

Or a Durex. Everyone wants to do it. I just feel like.

It's happening in pockets. It's not happening. In a linear way.

Homogenously. It will take time. Like your core.

Will still remain mass. But you will have. A valorized product.

For that mass brand. For the consumer. So you don't also.

Lose the consumer. Right. That's the thing.

That tastes are changing. So I want to keep. That consumer in my brand.

So I'll be like. Okay. I also have to have.

Something that I can upsell. Otherwise you'll move. To another brand.

Tell me one thing. In beauty. At the mass level.

100%. Which are the brands. That have scaled.

Above a thousand crores. Lakme. Is.

Mama. Mama. Would you put it in beauty.

Or would you put it in skin care. Beauty no. Yeah.

Mama. Mama is. You know.

Actually. What do you mean. Beauty skin care.

Beauty is. The higher one. Minimalist.

Like color cosmetics. Or whatever. Okay.

We need to teach these men. I think Lakme. Is the biggest example.

Not about mass. You're asking for premium brand. Right.

Which premium brand. I'm just saying. Yeah.

Premium brands. That have scaled. To a large.

Like 500 crores. I think it's starting. I don't think.

A premium has hit. Thousand yet. But I think.

In the years to come. It will. I mean.

MAC has taken time. But it's. It's the number three.

Color cosmetic brand. On the. You know.

When you look at. They do a thousand. A year.

Is that premium. Or prestige. That's premium.

Premium for sure. Like I see. For example.

So how big is that market. Shantanu. How big is the prestige market.

How big is the premium market. I think very small. Like I feel.

It's still very small. And it's growing fast. The prestige market.

Is 0.8 billion. USD. In what.

In what category. In beauty. In beauty.

Yeah. And I think. It's growing faster.

Than we expect. I have a feeling. I have a feeling.

Only the beauty market. That's my issue. So it'll still be.

All of us have this feeling. Because we live in that. We live in this world.

But you know. I think with India. What we need to always look at.

Is India's. Like consumers. And as a country.

I feel like it lives. In many different centuries. At the same time.

Like yes. The premium market. Is not as big.

But I just think. The middle class. And the luxury consumer.

Is growing. At a very fast rate. It's not as big as mass.

I agree. The pie there is way bigger. But I see it from my own brand.

Like if I look at my pricing. A couple years ago. People would just find that.

Very very expensive. For an Indian brand. And it's working.

Like. So for example. To aid your argument.

I would say okay fine. Mercedes for example. Is a 25,000 crore company in India.

It's four times the size of Colgate. But they just have to sell 25,000 cars. Yeah.

That's true. It's 25,000 cars. 25,000 crores.

If you have to sell a small volume. You can have a large premium. Luxury business.

But in beauty. I think it's a volume game also. I really really believe.

I believe in the consumer. I think the consumer wants quality. I think the consumer.

Wants good ingredients. And when you truly can give it. Like Indewald wouldn't exist otherwise.

Like they really do. Do you think to get to a thousand crores. You don't have to compromise on price.

You can do it at a 950 rupee hair oil. Yeah. You'll get to a thousand crores.

Yeah. I mean we also have the US luckily. No in India.

Oh in India purely. Eventually. I don't think in the next three years.

But I think eventually yes. It's also about what how much. If you can build a thousand crore brand.

If you're putting in like crazy amounts of money. But to do it purely on organic. Building it on with an organic mindset.

And doing it sustainably. Will take time. It's not easy to build a thousand crore.

Which is a high volume prestige game. That has happened in India. The last five years.

I think Minimalist came first. I mean look at Forest Essential. And Kamal Veera.

It's not about big. It's about them being able to. Capture market share.

In their market right. It's about. Then you're saying market is small.

Yeah. Of course the market is small. It's only 10.

Today it's 4%. How big is Kamal Veera? It must be around 400-500 crores. Some 500 crores.

You think. Today prestige is only 4% of the. Beauty market.

As I was telling him. It'll be 10% in the next 3-4 years. We all feel like.

Even I made that huge mistake. Of launching very premium. And then realizing that.

It'll remain a niche business. But no I don't agree with. I don't agree with your definition of premium.

Premium is not one thing right. What is premium to me. May not be premium to him.

Yes there's a definition of premium. On classification. But by category you can make out no.

Like Gadi for example. But that doesn't mean in mass. You're still premiumizing in mass.

You're still staying in mass. That is what I'm talking about. Is the trend.

That I agree. That's exactly what I'm saying. That your 10-12 rupee Colgate.

You'll maybe. You'll create a product. That is 10 rupees more expensive.

Right. You're not going. But that hasn't happened.

Look at Biscuit. Look at Chip. Gram is reduced.

Price is 10 bucks. I'm not saying it's happened. It is happening.

That's where everyone is saying that. As well right. Everyone is saying that.

I have a huge question mark on it. Because of inequity. I just feel.

All the money gets concentrated. In a small number of people. And then we fool ourselves.

Into believing this is a consumption story. We're seeing it getting stagnant. For the last three years now.

But there is that new. Like women entering the workforce. That is a new variable.

And young women. Having that disposable income. We have the highest unemployment rate.

Of women in the world. Our employment rate. In women is reducing.

Not increasing. But where are you? I think you're always looking at. From the lens of.

Like tier 2, tier 3. And I think we're always. Looking at it from the lens. Of tier 1 metro.

I think that's the big difference. But even metro. In metro.

How much of Bombay. Do you think is tier 1? In terms of income. Under 5. 100%.

No, I 100% agree with you. For that small number of. That for that 1 crore people.

You can do a million things. Yeah, absolutely. And we're not.

I don't think any of us are creating. For that 1 crore, right? They will. They have the ability.

To buy whatever they want. Travel wherever they want. And do whatever they want.

That's the ultra luxury. Yeah, we are creating. For a large, large audience.

And I think that. You are creating. For the largest audience.

And I think at Reliance. We do also everything at scale. You have to do it.

For the majority. I just feel like. If you want to build.

A large business. You have to do it. You have to.

It's the belly of the market. 100%. The price will have to start eroding.

And what according to you. Is the definition of a large business. 1000 CR.

So let's talk oils. Oil. Let's say parachute is what? 5, 4000 crores.

The largest oil business. Yeah. In terms of beauty oils.

If you want to get to 25% of parachute. Your average order value. Will have to come from 950 to 400.

In my view. In my view. But what would make.

What would make it a successful business. If I hit 1000 CR. You'd be like.

That's successful. No, no. That's totally up to you.

You can totally say that. Boss I want to build a. Like Forest Essentials promoter. Will say that the most successful business.

Because they build a great brand. And it is. It is the scale at which it is.

But I think. Like if for example. If you want people to become entrepreneurs.

You have to aim for the stars. And then be okay to fall on the moon. So large markets.

With large outcome possibilities. Should be a starting point fairly. In my view.

I just feel. I feel that. The illusion of scale.

In large price points. Because it is aspirational. Is very high.

Do you think ironically enough. You need a larger. Capital pie.

To go after the mass market. And a smaller one for the premium market. It is very expensive.

To go after the mass market. It is very expensive. Because it's.

We have 5 million retailers. And it is capex heavy. To go after 5 million retailers.

And you'd rather go top down. Than bottom up. I think with quick commerce.

It is changing a little bit. So earlier you could build a. At 100 crores. You'd say okay.

At 100 crores. Now a beauty. Or an apparel.

Or a food. F&B brand. Has to go into stores.

Today that number is now 500. You can build a good. 500 crore business.

80% online. And some amount in modern trade. And still do well.

Like we are. We are 500 crores. Do you think the pathway would be.

To build a premium brand. And then trickle down. Yes.

To an extent yes. Because you set aspiration. And then you can kind of.

Sub-brand it out. Or make more product. That's how I feel.

Like Mama Earth has done. A good job with that. Right.

But I just feel. You have to do it. Or you acquire a brand.

Or you become more. You start a sub-brand. Which is accessible.

Because I think we. I feel. I see so.

I have invested also. In so many entrepreneurs. Who think big.

And then they just see the market. Just. Just fall off a cliff.

That universe becomes so limited. Additional customer acquisition. Becomes so expensive.

Do we fear. A lot of what we are discussing today. Is what Indian brands can sell.

Outside of India. Fair. That's a very different story.

That's a very different story. And I think that's. That's a fair point.

I think that's how it should be. You know. We should.

Inspire people to build brands. Not just for India. But outside of it.

Very Indian in nature brands. India has the ability. To do it as well.

We are the largest. Motorcycle seller in Africa. Bajaj is.

Beat in China. Chinese motorcycle players. Scooters.

Three wheelers. All of that. But that's because the.

Really large western markets. Or Chinese markets. Are not two wheeler heavy.

Yes. Also true. So I think we have figured.

Figured that out. I think for example in Dubai. Huge opportunity in the US.

Huge. Absolutely. With oils.

And GCC as well. UK as well. UK were already there.

When we were told. When we were told. When we started.

I want to build a global brand for India. It has to have global appeal. Blah blah blah.

So one of my friends from Unilever. I told him. Tell me some name options.

Which is Indian in nature. And has global appeal. He did some research.

And he came back after a few days. And he's like. You have four options.

Himalaya. Taj. Gandhi.

Bombay. These are the four words. Which you can have pure.

Which are Indian in nature. And have global appeal. Himalaya and Taj were taken.

Gandhi said it will be political suicide. So Bombay is what you have to do. And then we built out Bombay.

So that was one of the first things. We want to build a global business. Oh you know.

Like Indowild for example. Is something you came up with. But starting point was that.

A tier two is an opportunity. I know Purple is doing well there. Beyond metros.

Beyond huge. Yeah. Yeah.

How does one hit that market? I think for example. I think. I really think we should just kind of.

Go with marketplaces. Who are building out infrastructure. Do you find that tier two is going to Purple.

Not coming to Tira. No tier two is coming as well. I think it's about.

As I said. It is about premiumization. At every lever.

We are. We're really. I don't think that.

We are only speaking to the. The metro audience. I think what we wanted to create.

Is a platform for. For the Indian consumer of today right. And that consumer is not just sitting in tier one.

They are sitting in tier two. And tier three. And in fact.

There is at least 5x headroom. 5x times headroom. To grow in terms.

In terms of acquisition. And you know. Even premiumization.

Like a huge amount of prestige sales. Come from tier two. And tier three cities.

So we should not assume that. Those consumers are buying value. They have the ability.

They have the. They also have the. Wallet share to be able to spend.

Spend on those things. So there is huge amount of untapped. Untapped revenue.

Acquisition all in. All beyond metros. Because those consumers.

There is aspiration at every level. There is as I said. There is aspiration and premiumization at every level.

And there is so much untapped potential there. We should actually make the distinction between. Income India one.

India two. India three. And urban rural India one.

India two. India three. So tier two India.

If you in fact look at the top 5% households. In a Ludhiana or a Nasik or a Coimbatore. Will probably have much higher disposable income.

Than the top 5% in a. Let's say Pune or an Ahmedabad. Because. The cost of living is so much lower.

You end up saving. And then you will want to have tier. But I want to ask you.

Are you thinking quick. Like Blinket is now in 200 cities. And they are like expanding.

And in tier two. For example the good part about tier two India. Is you need only two Blinket stores.

To serve the whole city. I know a friend who is starting quick commerce. Specifically for beauty.

Oh. Quick commerce for x has now become. Yeah quick commerce for fashion.

God! So much money. Quick commerce for this. For food.

Fashion is crazy. Quick commerce for food? Yeah. Five minutes.

For that Zomato? No, no. Zomato has bistro or whatever. Cafe or whatever.

You know what the offering is? Two minute cook time. Eight minute delivery time. Food is being made in two minutes.

In eight minutes. Who is cooking? Who is doing this cooking? Some cloud kitchen with like ready stuff. Yeah.

Couple of weeks ago. I was interviewing Dara. The Uber CEO.

In the US. He had a very interesting take on this. The American markets.

Skipped quick commerce. Because they had big box retail. And he said.

Quick commerce can work in very densely populated societies. But the distinction is. How many people in that society are willing to pay.

A dollar. Two dollars. Five dollars a day.

In perpetuity. Because the labor arbitrage comes in. If this building has.

I don't know. 30 houses or 50 houses. And we all use quick commerce.

A couple of times a day. And we're spending a few thousand rupees. At some point it gets to the point where.

People start thinking okay. A few thousand rupees a day. Is a few lakh rupees a month.

Should we hire five boys. Who will not only go and bring the grocery. But they also do errands at home.

It works in high. High cost of labor societies somehow. In India I don't know.

I don't know what the time is. I don't think. It's much more than 50-60 million people.

If with all. That's a large time. But not more.

Five crore people are a large time. All these companies have two. Two lakh.

Three lakh crore market caps. So time is reciprocal of that right. I don't know.

It's a tough question. I've never bought. All of them are my friends.

But I've never bought from quick commerce. I've never invested in a quick commerce. You have ordered.

Yeah. Yeah. It's not becoming a feature.

So for example. Nika is now doing sub two hour delivery. In Bombay and Bangalore.

Like for D2C brands. There are no companies that do quick commerce. They'll say.

For these pin codes. We'll deliver in six hours. You just.

We'll have a. But I'll tell you. This is again labor arbitrage. Uber does this exact same thing.

Where their riders are not employees. They can't have unions. They don't get.

Pensions and medical. And this that and the other. When seven eight players.

Come into the foray. And they start unionizing. And they start asking for benefits.

At some point. That cost. To convenience math.

Will get skewed. And not for the better. But that's what happened.

With Uber and Ola. Also in India no. Yeah.

Market tapped out very quickly. Yeah. And then all that.

Supply of cars became problematic. Yeah. Rapido is like the upcoming thing.

From Bangalore. Bombay. Only with Rapido now.

Yeah. Only Rapido yeah. Gurgaon, Bombay, Bangalore.

Only Rapido. Pradeep will kill me for saying this. But yeah.

Uber is too expensive. Who's Pradeep? Pradeep is now. Was Asia head for Uber.

Is now working in Dara's team. I think on their enterprise. He's one of my investors.

Ayurveda. Ayurveda was a novelty a few years ago. Is it still? I don't think it's a novelty.

I think as she said it's about. In the pre-actives era. Right now it's all actives right? Now it's about how do you.

If you can take Ayurveda and. And actives and put it together. And you know.

Get the benefit of as you said. The natural. The holistic.

So in beauty I think there's always been. Two lanes. Like there's people who like clean.

Which is all natural. Herbal. And then there's clinical.

Which is the dermats. The actives. And I think there's a new.

Trend or phase that's coming up. Where it's clinical. So it's the clean and the clinical.

AKA hybrid. And I think Ayurveda. Is having that phase now.

So I think the brands like. Kama Forest that are pure Ayurveda. Are there.

But I think. It's a different demographic. That they serve.

And I think brands like India Wild. Which are clinical. Ayurvedistry is the term we coined.

Like Ayurveda meets chemistry. Is that how you would describe India Wild? Yeah. That's the main I think bucket.

Is that we formulate. And we kind of do everything under Ayurvedistry. Which even is that friction point.

I was talking about earlier. Where the consumer is Ayurvedistry. You can have food.

That's Ayurvedistry. Which basically just means fusion. Of Ayurveda and the chemistry.

Or the science back things. And I think that is easily. Acceptable to the new consumer.

Did you just reason out. Did yeah. Who was the investor? Unilever.

They led it but we had two more. Venture or like Unilever from the balance sheet. Ventures yeah.

In India? No in the global office. How large was the round? We raised five. Million.

Yeah. At like a. 4x, 5x. Ish yeah.

And you're selling 8 to 10. No 12 million now. This year we're gonna hit 12 in net yeah.

The company really has grown a lot. In the last 12 months. Thanks to.

India is just. Exploding for us. Exploding like US is doing really well.

But we're only on dot com in the US. At this point. UK we're dot com and Sephora.

But Sephora is tiny there. It's seven stores. And India is just.

Like it's the retail side. It's our dot com side. It's just really yeah.

How much is direct to customer? Um I'd say. We still do 40% direct. And 60 is between all our retailers.

But changing. Retail is taking the pie. Like every month.

More yeah. Would you be open to someone coming in. And getting equity in your company? Like significant.

Do you mean you? Me or anyone watching this. I mean right now. I don't think we're fundraising.

But I think we'll probably do series A next year. But right now we're good yeah. But yes always come meet me.

Have coffee. That's always welcome for that. We know sometimes with these things.

It's before you get into a marriage. You need to court. So um.

We're always happy to have coffee. Yeah. Interesting.

Your story after McKinsey. We didn't get there. How did you get to here from there? I think.

I was a part of the cohort of branding. There was a lot of infrastructural things. Happening in India at that time right.

We had Jio and Airtel. And Xiaomi and iPhones. And Samsung putting phones.

And internet in people's hands. But Amazon, Flipkart, Facebook, Google. Giving you know.

Giving us ability to you know. Market products and store them. And we had a consumer base that was truly changing.

Because of Virat and Ranveer at that time. With beards and expression right. So masculine trends were really taking off.

In terms of in terms of styling. And hair removal was going from cheek to chin. And ankle to thigh waxing.

And cheek to chin shaving. To like whole body hair removal. So there was infrastructure.

There was distribution. And then there was consumer which was changing. So for us I think.

There's a whole host of brands. So Boat, Mama Earth, Plum. Bombay Shaving Company.

All of us was a part of that. 10-year-old. We are now all 10, 12, 8-year-old businesses today.

Thank you so much. This is like protein powder and yogurt. And this has.

You're really spoiling us. Everything has been so delicious. Thank you so much.

Really really delicious. Pragati is cooking. And she's really good.

This has creatine. Protein powder. Dark chocolate.

Plus some nuts. You're really in your longevity journey. Trying.

I like that. Amazing. Is there magnesium in it? No.

So we started as a premium shaving business. We thought that you know. We can build a good shaving brand.

It became very niche. Went into men's grooming. And then after COVID we realized that you know.

Hair removal is a big place. So we went into trimmers. We went into women.

With our brand Bombay. And today we are now 500 crores net. Profitable.

Ibidda and Pat both. I love that we speak in net. Yeah.

Cash positive over the last 3-4 months. Cash balances are going up. Good investor base.

And 170-180 people. With 99% of our business in India. Which is something we want to change now.

We do believe that there is a brand pull. That is significant outside the country for us. Especially amongst Indian consumers.

So we are very focused. That if we are in the universe. Which removes hair off your body.

In that 10 minutes when you go into the bathroom. Brush your teeth. Take a shave.

Use the loo. Take a shower. Come out.

Put on a fragrance. After shave and leave. In that 10-15 minutes.

We want to be a big part of your life. And that's the brand. And that's what we do.

It's very simple. We don't do rocket science. We are an unremarkable company that way.

But we do the small thing very well. But it's crazy scale. So it's super impressive.

Yeah. To give you a sense. In Covid 2021.

So we will do more EBITDA this year. Than the revenue in 2021. So naturally.

Yeah. So that's the 5 year journey. First 5 years was struggle and discovery.

Next 5 years have been good scale. But still 500 crores is nothing. I don't think it's a large scale business yet.

Gillette is 2500 crores. Philips. Trim all this 1000 crores.

But can you take a second. And believe that you've built it. Like from ground.

So I think that is commendable. You know for sure. I think.

And a sustainable. You know profitable business. Is what everybody wants.

I'm very proud of what the team has done. I think the brand is very good. I genuinely feel like we are a brand that.

People will think that we are premium. When they see our logo. Or when they see our product.

But when they see the price. They'll go this is pretty cheap. Like you know.

You'll get like a 20 rupees razor. So our brand goes from 1 rupee blades. To 7000 rupee trimmers.

The width is pretty large. 1 rupee blades. Yeah we sell the 1 rupee blade.

Which you sharpen your pencil with in school. Yeah it's called Sharp Max. Bombay shaving company.

Sharp Max. Pack of 10, 100 rupees. Like pack of 100, 100 rupees.

Yeah. Which barbers use and so on. And who's your average customer? So we've realized over a period of time.

For men. We've realized that. We started as with older consumers.

But we realized you're taking sharp metal to your face. So if you've used Gillette for a long time. It's unlikely you're going to change.

So men are hard to engage. Easy to please. Women are easy to engage.

Hard to please. The fundamental difference in consumption. So we realized.

Boss. All of life is like that. It's too difficult.

I'm stealing that. Yeah. It's too difficult to like you know.

But women are easy to engage. But then the product has to be really good. With men.

You put a good shaving foam. Does the job. They're happy.

They keep repeating right. So then we realized. The idea is actually to get in early.

So when you're going to shave. Shave for the first time. You're 15 years old.

You have a small mustache. Sideburns. Want to take it off.

Like that's when. So our brand has become a lot younger. For 16-17 year old.

How do you find them? So we do a lot. So Instagram and social. For young consumers.

We do a lot of college activations. Like very Red Bull. Approach to like.

We run the barbershop for young people. Very young DG. Very.

The first time you shave. So the first product a man would buy. In our age group.

Or all of our age group. Would probably be a 25 rupee razor. At the age of 18.

How old are you? I'm 37. 34. 35.

38. The oldest. So in all of our age groups.

We would. The first product a man would buy. Would be a 25 rupee razor.

At the age of 18. But the first product a boy is buying. Is a 500 rupee trimmer.

At the age of 14. And Gillette is not in trimmers. So we have a four year runway.

Before they can get into Bombay. So we have 15% market share. In trimmers all India.

We sell 7000 trimmers a day. 7000 trimmers a day all India. At a 1000 rupee price point.

That's why the price point. Becomes so important for me. Like you know.

If I can premiumise. So the idea is. You come with me.

When you buy your first razor. At least you'll use a trimmer. For some four years.

You'll choose Bombay shaving company. But if you're 25, 27, 28. You've used Gillette for 10 years.

You're used to it. There's no way you're changing. There's no way.

It's too good a product. Gillette's too good. So that's the idea.

Thank you. I don't want chocolate all over me. Sorry.

There you go. Thank you. You guys are serving us.

The wrong food. For a good podcast. Yeah.

Yum though right? Yeah but noodles. And chocolate. It's like slurping the noodle up.

Oh yeah. And we're still like. We did the whole GT thing.

By the way. We went into offline stores. Boss you need to really.

Be prepared for this stuff. And we have Colgate. Palmolive.

And Record Bankies. Are two successful global. Offline businesses.

As investors. Who taught us how to do it. Wow good.

But until the brand pool is there. Assortment sharpness is there. And pricing is right.

Anyone watching this. General trade. Just be super careful.

Start in a small city. Around a dark store. That's doing well.

Try one or two in the neighborhood. Then only you can take it. Okay last part of today.

We need step two. Now Dilip has figured out. His fragrance brand.

I'm back to Dilip. Four of us should create. This fragrance brand at the end.

Oh my god. It would be so good. Yeah it'll be fun.

Okay Dilip. Fragrance or Deepa's. I don't know.

Keepa has started a. New kind of hair oil. Or somebody started a marketplace. Or some new men's grooming.

Product has started. What do they do next? The idea is here. I know what to make.

How do I make it? Who do I go to? Copacker. How do I sort out manufacturing. It's just the idea phase.

Just the idea. Idea phase we have crossed now. Okay.

Where is Dilip's idea? It's on paper. Yeah. 25 years old.

He's going to. Promote his. Promote it as not about the bottle.

The name of the company is Temple. He's going to try and get. Frag heads.

Community going. Think of flavors like. Old Spice plus Agarbatti.

Vanilla plus some camphor. Temple something. Stuff like that.

Solid. So he's gotten that far. Okay.

And now. He needs to go out and. Manufacture the product.

Where does he go? Trade shows. Like. There's a huge one in Italy.

That happens every year. In Bologna called Cosmoprof. There's also Cosmoprof in India now.

Every country has their own. Like these. Manufacturer hubs.

They come from all over the world. And you can go there. Walk around for two, three days.

Talk to every manufacturer. About everything. And you'll also meet.

Packaging. You know. Packaging experts.

You'll meet. Contract manufacturers. Who will be like.

Okay this is your idea. We'll do everything for you. End to end.

Sometimes they even get into branding. So they'll be like. We'll brand it for you.

Tell us your idea. We'll do end to end. For you.

And they will. Touch me. If I have.

Say demand for. A hundred pieces. So five.

Not all. I think few manufacturers. Will have a low.

Like MOQs. So then you can be like. Only a thousand I want.

Or they'll be like. No our minimum is ten thousand. But for a thousand.

They'll do it more expensive. Per unit. And generally.

Like if you're doing. There's open molds. And custom molds.

So if you're doing. Smaller quantities. It's very expensive.

To make a custom mold. So you want a particular shape. So generally.

Lot of young. And we discussed that. It's not about the bottle anymore.

So how do you kind of. A lot of brands. Use generic bottles.

Even like bigger brands. Because it is expensive. And you can't get.

A huge amount of MOQs. You know say ten thousand. Or twenty thousand.

For that one SKU. And then change the mold. So generically.

All of this advice. You'll get from. Your contract manufacturer.

And packaging. The good part about India. Is because.

All the contract manufacturing. Is written on the back of pack. Yeah.

You're crazy guys. I find that so crazy. You'll know every manufacturer.

Within like a day. And then you can just. Go and talk to them.

Because. And I think with fragrances. Particularly I think.

MOQs are very low. Crazy hack. That you're giving everyone.

But it's insane. You can literally find out. People's manufacturers.

Yeah you know exactly. Actually that's easy. If I like a good product.

I can just call you. Write a sharp brief. And get an 80% answer.

Within a week. Yeah but they should have. NDAs and like.

Contracts in place. So they don't give the formula away. Yeah.

They'll tweak it a little bit. Yeah. Is there something like.

Patenting my perfume? No. Not patent and perfume. Unless like the odor technology.

Whatever we're talking about. That you could probably patent. But just purely the notes.

No you can't patent that. You can keep it secret. So many dupes.

Like the dupe market. Is a whole different market. Yeah.

It's insane. Yeah. Insane.

And people are like. People use dupes. And they say that they use dupes.

Because they're very smart. And there's a whole community. About telling you.

Which is the best dupe. By dupe you don't mean. Like a Chanel is called Chanel.

No it's duplicate. No no. It's a Bella Vita.

He says this is Chanel number 5. Yeah. And you can even tell the manufacturer. That I want to create this.

Make it 60% closer to this. It's very easy to make. Anything that is water or gas based.

Broadly. And as you said. Everything is inspired.

So something has been inspired. From someone. So it's all circular.

What you can also do. Is like benchmark. A fragrance you like.

Be like make it like this. But give me more oud. Oud yeah.

Give me more. Increase the percent. Oudie or give me more spice.

Or something. And then the manufacturer can like. At least use it as a baseline.

So you're not full copy copying. But. But it's a bit.

But that's the reason. Innovation is so rare. In our industry.

And that's why you know. Companies like L'Oreal. Estee Lauder.

They win. And they have products. Whose formulations don't change.

Over 15 to 20 years. It's because there's. So there's hard hard coded.

Time and energy spent. On research and development. Innovation and technology.

That comes together. To kind of create a product. That surpasses it right.

Whatever you do. You will not be able to create that. And I think that.

You can't take that away. So I think when you want. To create something.

Clutter breaking. It's either a great. Storytelling.

Or you know. An idea like minimalist. Or solid product.

That is. That is innovation led. L'Oreal is so good.

No I just innovate. Like out of this world. Yeah.

But they also keep buying. Over like biotech companies. Yes.

To constantly keep that. Innovation wheelhouse going. But that's why brands.

That are smaller like us. We need to. Go find that innovation.

In a Korea. In a Japan. And then.

Take our Indian ingredients. And mix it to bring that. Proprietary kind of.

Something to the formula. You know that. Either makes the delivery.

Of the niacinamide. Deeper into your skin. With things like.

Exosomes and stuff. That like deliver. The ingredient better.

So you're like yes. It's still niacinamide. But our serum.

Is going to deliver it. To you stronger. Or you do it.

Based on ingredients. Or you do it. Based on the texture itself.

Like it's the. Most unique. Sunscreen texture.

You've ever felt. Because in the humidity. Just melts in your skin.

Like so. There's something. That I think as a brand.

You have to give. Your customer. That's then.

Different than. Every other. Kind of cookie cutter.

The greatest story. In your. In this world.

Was actually. Darshan bhai. In 2010-11.

When he said that. My perfume lasts longer. We don't need.

This whole aerosol technology. Let's put water. And gas.

Give it in a can. And we call it deodorant. And Fog.

Is a thousand crore business. Built off of. Great marketing.

And a product. That lasts long. F-O-G-G.

The deodorant brand. Max was 40% market share. Fog came in.

Within 4 years. They're at 25% market share. H-O-L brand.

Is losing market share. Quarter on quarter. On quarter.

Insane. So if she's right. One.

One thing. Would be known for it. Hero product.

And the same applies. For my. Nikhil's.

Skincare. Morning. Night.

Supplement business. Trade shows. I think trade shows.

Is a great start. For you to be able. To meet.

See everyone. Brands. Manufacturers.

Build a network. Which is the next trade show? Maybe we'll throw it up. Where in India? Yeah.

I think India only Cosmoprof. Yeah there's Cosmoprof. That happens in India.

But there's Cosmoprof. That happens in Vegas. There's Cosmoprof.

That happens in Italy. Those are the biggest ones. Like US, Korea.

And stuff have many. Many. You go to Canton also.

Canton is a great place to go. In China. Oh ha.

For packaging. No in general. For everything.

Going to build trimmers. Packaging. Manufacturers.

Everything. Canton is like the world. Even Korea has.

Through the year. They have many conventions. And trade festivals.

And it's a great start. Particularly if you don't. Have any.

If you don't know anyone. In the industry. It's great to go build.

That contact network. It's fine yeah. Yeah and also.

There'll be smaller manufacturers. Who you'll want to work with. Who'll you know.

Be able to. Suit to your. Your scale.

And help you innovate. And take that time. And then move to.

Once you've got it. Okay this is what I'm going to do. And there you can.

Indeed as a small brand. It's going to be a lot harder. To go to a really big.

That builds. For the biggest brands. Because they're like.

Sorry but no. You don't have scale. But one that's.

Starting up themselves. Then I think. That would be a good fit.

Yeah okay. Last word guys. Any advice.

To somebody starting tomorrow. I think mine would be. Definitely identify.

Your white space. Have a hero product strategy. And really.

I think there's. There's this thing about like. Perfection right.

You want to get. Everything right. I think.

Keep building that momentum. And getting out there. It's not about beauty.

It's just about really. Keep on going. And it's about progress.

Not perfection. So I think that is something. That really.

That I keep telling myself. That okay. What's the next move.

So be agile. And that'll really help you. Because you can adapt.

So I think for me. That's what I would tell anyone. That yeah in beauty.

Definitely white space. Storytelling. And hero product.

Are three things. And community. To kind of build your brand.

And we'll put out. Bhakti's email. So people can reach out.

People find Bhakti. And email me. So that I think is.

Is already happening. But you might get. A great funnel of good ideas.

Absolutely. Mine would be. Remember your why.

I think through tough times. And good times. That'll keep you going.

And as a brand. Especially when you're building. It's very much for the community.

And like for it to mean something. And then secondly I would say. Build a winning team.

Like I think you as one person. Can do so much. But having an incredible team around you.

Marry them. Huh? Marry them. That helps.

That's a big one. Marry them. It can't be easy to work with your husband.

I know people say that. But one of those. We're one of those crazy couples.

That is. And Bhakti's witnessed it live. But we're so happy to be with each other.

All the time. That even if we. Like are away.

For 24 hours. We're like. Oh I miss you.

Like. But I think. From a business perspective.

We have very complementary skill sets. Like he. He was an ex-diplomat.

And he's really a. Kind of. People's collaborative leader. And I'm much more like.

The solo vision kind of leader. And I'm much more marketing. And storytelling.

And it's all in here. I need to bring it out. And he's so much more about.

You know. And it's just really complementary. Like I think without him.

Indie World wouldn't exist. So yeah. Very grateful to work with him.

But also the team that we build together. Is so important. Where is the team based? In Bombay.

Our HQ is Lower Peral. Lovely. Come by.

I would love to. I would love to. I think.

For me I think. The most important thing. For entrepreneurs is that.

This will be a. Decades long gig. It's not going to be a small. And you've experienced it yourself.

And if you look at. Mukesh had actually told me this from Myntra. He said.

Very interesting thing. He said look. Look at companies that have lasted 20 years.

You'll see 93% of their market value. Is created in the second decade. Only 7% in the first.

See companies that have lasted three decades. Almost 80% is in the third decade. 15 or 17 in the second.

And only three or four in the first. So. In today's world of instant gratification.

Is that many companies last three decades anymore? Amazon. He was giving me examples of Amazon and Meta. And in India I think like.

Is Meta three decades old already? No, no. Google is three decades. Meta is probably two decades.

I think a lot of companies die in like eight, ten years. Huh. So if you.

If you. But the thing is with. In a world of instant gratification.

And. Wanting to. Tell the story of your startup.

Before the startup is even there. Because we are building communities. And we are on Instagram.

And we want our friends to know. We are entrepreneurs and blah blah blah. And the first sign of failure.

And I'm noticing this with like a whole cohort of. Companies we invested in 21, 22. And suddenly founders are like.

It's been three years. Nothing is happening, boss. It's a 10 lakh month business.

What do we do? Not worth it. I'm gonna. Grit.

Yeah. So I think patience. And knowing that this is.

Like there's opportunity cost. And there is a. Very long zone of frustration. For most good companies.

Even the most successful ones. So just go through it. But don't become a zombie company.

Where you are doing something. Which is totally not worth it. And there just because you are

surviving.

So don't do that. But. Going and know that this will take 20 years.

At the very least. To see the first signs of something meaningful. Fund life cycle that.

Prashant is here. He'll know. Everyone promises 8 year life cycle.

It's 13, 14 years. India is a country where you need 15, 20 years. To find something meaningful.

We run all perpetual funds. Huh? We run all perpetual funds. No fund life.

What's your takeaway from. Spending 3 hours with us on beauty. 4 hours.

4 hours. Wow. A. If there is a Dilip listening.

That idea is yours. You can have it. On the fragrance.

Before. Unless we do it first. Unless they do it first.

But. I think. Tomorrow we will care a lot more.

For how we look. As a means of getting validation. So anything that aids that will likely grow.

Both in the mass and the premium segment. I think the affluent will probably adapt faster. So the premium will go.

Significantly faster than mass. So it feels like a good category to be in. And as an investor.

Strangely enough. There aren't enough listed Indian players. Which allow you allocation into this category.

So. Lots of room and potential for someone to build here. Beauty for example.

So many new companies. I see Foxtail. And DU.

And Deconstruct. And Pilgrim. Large scale in the wild.

Like large scale businesses now. Like look at Minimalist. They were like 3-4 years to it.

Yeah. I think 4-5. Yeah.

Wild. Crazy. Very well done.

Done. Thank you guys. Thank you so much.

Thank you for having us. So nice to meet both of you as well. 4 hours weren't like 30 minutes.

Went by super fast. When you're having fun and eating yummy food. Yeah.

Thank you so much. Thank you so much. For bringing all of us together.